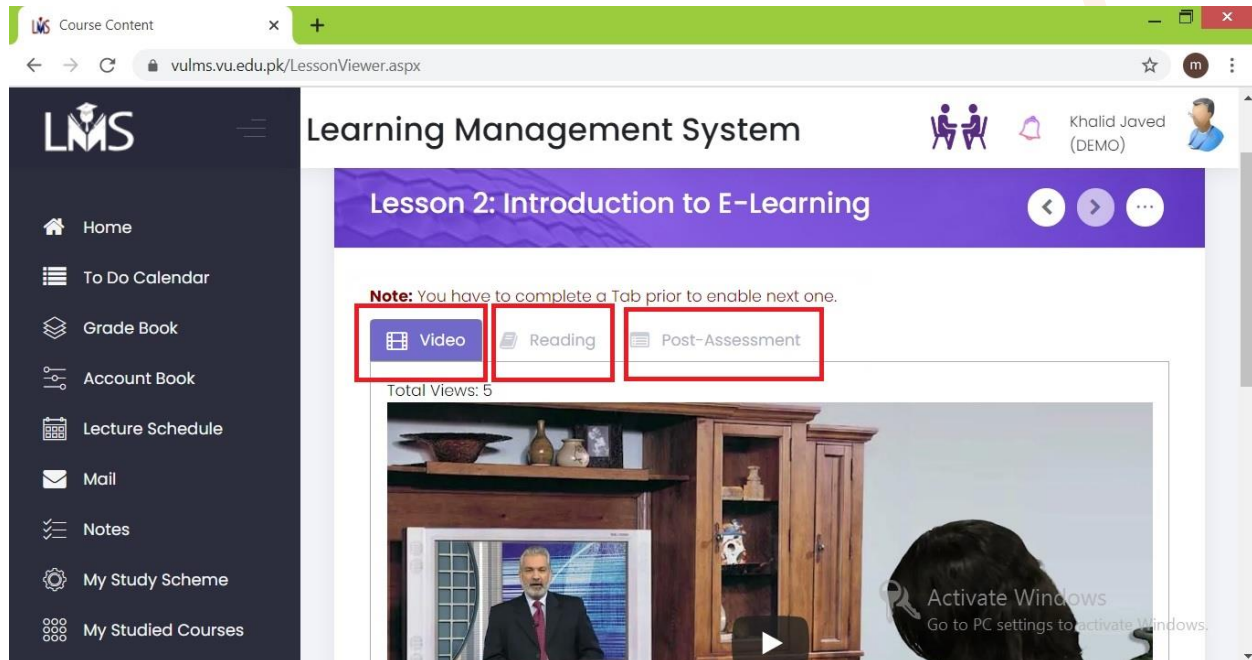


**VU001\_Handouts**

# **VU001 - Introduction to e-Learning**

## Lesson 1: How to start and complete this course

1. The course is comprised of 11 topics/videos. Each video is followed by “**Reading**” and “**Post Assessment**” activities. On clicking the link of any topic, you will find next page containing three tabs “**Video**”, “**Reading**” and “**Post Assessment**” as shown in the screenshots given below:



2. You will have to go through all the tabs one by one to proceed further to next topic.
3. At first, you will find none of the topic links as active except “How to start and complete the course”. However, after carefully reading this topic and on completing the time reserved for this activity, the link of next topic “**Introduction to e-Learning**” will become active.

Learning Management System

Index / Lesson

**Note:** You have to complete a Lesson/Topic prior to enable next one. ✓ Studied

| Sr. No. | Title                                 | Activity | MDB Comments | Duration |
|---------|---------------------------------------|----------|--------------|----------|
| 1       | How to start and complete this course |          | Closed       | 00:10:00 |
| 2       | Introduction to E-Learning            |          | Closed       | 00:30:49 |
| 3       | Introduction to VU                    |          | Closed       | 00:10:00 |

4. You will have to click the topic link.
5. At first, “**Reading**” and “**Post Assessment**” tabs will be inactive as shown in the screenshot given below:

Lesson 2: Introduction to E-Learning

**Note:** You have to complete a Tab prior to enable next one.

Video Reading Post-Assessment

Total Views: 5

6. To watch the topic video, you need to click on the “**Play**” button.
7. On watching the complete video, the “**Reading**” tab located right across the “**Video**” tab will be activated.
8. You will have to click the “**Reading**” tab and have to thoroughly read the topic content.

9. On reading all the topic content and completing the time reserved for this activity, the “**Post-Assessment**” tab located right across the “**Reading**” tab will be activated.
10. You will have to click the “**Post-Assessment**” tab that will lead you to a short Quiz pertaining to the video, you watched.
11. You will have to attempt complete Quiz in order to activate the link of next topic.
12. The same steps will be followed for next each of the topics.

**Note:**

- This is a non-graded and free of cost course having no graded assessment such as Assignments, Quizzes, Graded Discussion, Mid and Final term examinations.
- This is one credit hour course and the duration of the course is two weeks (till the last date of course add/drop). You will have to complete the course within prescribed duration.
- In case of failure to complete the course within the prescribed duration, you will have to re-enroll the course in next semester.

**Lesson 2: Introduction to e-Learning**

E-Learning is basically an abbreviation of electronic learning. In simple words, it can be quoted as the delivery of learning and training through digital devices such as computers, tablets and even cellular phones that are connected to the Internet. This makes it easy for users to learn anytime and from anywhere without any restrictions. Let’s watch a video to learn more about E-Learning.

**Content for Video:**

- I. What is E-Learning?
- II. Types of E-Learning
- III. VU Methodology
- IV. Pre-requisites for E-Learning
- V. Benefits of E-Learning
- VI. E-Learning Software/tools

I. What is E-Learning?

- Gartner defines e-Learning as "The use of technology for learning in or outside of a classroom."
- E-learning is also defined as providing Training and development to the Students/Employees through various electronic media such as the Internet, audio, and video etc.

II. Types of E-Learning

E-Learning typically falls into two categories: *Asynchronous* and *Synchronous*

1. *Asynchronous E-Learning:*

- This kind of E-Learning does not require instructors and students to be online simultaneously.
- Students learning through this mode use reading material available online or attend:
  - Pre-recorded audio/ video lectures available on Internet.
  - Lectures available in the form of CDs/DVDs.
  - Video lectures available/ broadcasted through TV Channels.
- Besides, students use Learning management system, discussion forums, message boards, emails and other related resources /platforms.

## 2. Synchronous e-Learning:

- It happens in real-time, meaning learners and instructors are online at the same time.
- In this type of E-Learning, lessons are delivered in a virtual classroom, and students use live chat, video conferencing, and application sharing to participate in the course.

## III. E-Learning Mode in VU:

- VU has adopted hybrid approach (*i.e., combination of both Asynchronous and Synchronous*).
- Through VU-LMS, using asynchronous mode, students can watch video lectures and submit assignments etc. at any time during specific time period.
- VU also conducts online sessions (*i.e., synchronous mode*), where students can have live chat with their instructors and discuss course related issues and get guidelines.

## IV. Pre-requisites for E-Learning:

- As discussed earlier, E-learning is delivered through digital devices. Therefore, learners are required to have some latest gadgets according to their educational needs.
- At VU, all the basic gadgets / pre-requisites of E-Learning such as Computer Systems, Internet and required services for the studies are available in the VU campuses. All those students who get admission as “a campus-based student” can use such facilities in their respective campuses during the office hours.
- However, all other students i.e. who get admission as “home based student” or as "Overseas", have to arrange their Computer/Laptop/Smart mobile phone and proper Internet connection at their own.

## V. Benefits of E-learning:

E-Learning has so many benefits; some of them are given below.

### 1. Saves Time and Money:

- You can manage your schedule and take online courses at your most convenient time.
- You save money too, because you don't have to pay for transportation or worry about eating on the go.

## 2. *Better Retention:*

- E-Learning makes use of different platforms like Pedagogue, which provides interactive content.
- You can share your thoughts and opinions with others easily.

## 3. *Personalized Learning:*

- You can choose your learning path and study at your own pace.
- You can become more motivated in the course.

## 4. *Cost-effective:*

- Many educational institutions save money through this set-up because there is no need to use a physical classroom, which translates to reduce monetary spending.

## 5. *Environment-friendly:*

- E-Learning is also more environmentally friendly because it doesn't contribute to the pollution brought about by paper production.

## VI. E-Learning Software/tools

Here's a list of some tools that can develop E-Learning modules and online training platforms very easy and convenient to use.

### 1. *Moodle:*

- It is designed to provide educators, administrators, and learners with an open, robust, secure and free platform to create and deliver personalized learning environments.

### 2. *Google Class Room:*

- Strong collaborative focus, easy to set up classes and assignments, virtual classes with Google Meet.

### 3. *Seesaw:*

- It creates a powerful learning loop between teachers, students, and parents.

### 4. *Safe Exam Browser (SEB):*

- It turns any computer temporarily into a secure workstation.
- It controls access to resources like system functions, other websites and applications and prevents unauthorized resources being used during an exam.



## 5. VU-LMS:

- Virtual University-Learning Management System (VU-LMS) is a comprehensive software platform that plays a critical role in the VU mode of study.
- By using this platform, VU students can:
  - Post their course related queries which are replied within 24-Hours.
  - See lesson contents and videos; can perform semester activities such as assignments, quizzes, discussions and online Labs.
- VULMS can be accessed from the link; <https://vulms.vu.edu.pk/>

### **Lesson 3: Introduction to VU**

The Virtual University, Pakistan's first University based completely on modern Information and Communication Technologies, was established by the Government as a public sector, not-for-profit institution with a clear mission: to provide extremely affordable world class education to aspiring students not only all over the country as well as all over the world. Using free-to-air satellite television broadcasts and the Internet, the Virtual University allows students to follow its rigorous programs regardless of their physical locations. It thus aims at alleviating the lack of capacity in the existing universities while simultaneously tackling the acute shortage of qualified professors in the country. By identifying the top Professors of the country, regardless of their institutional affiliations, and requesting them to develop and deliver hand-crafted courses, the Virtual University aims at providing the very best courses to not only its own students but also to students of all other universities in the country.

The university has brought the revolution in the field of education. VU is among the big universities of the country where more than 100000 students are getting education in different disciplines. Degree holders of this university are posted on good designations in national and international institutions. A number of such students are running their businesses in a better way. Revolutionary education system provides the students not only the quality education but also the skills to perform well in their professional career.

VU also provides the opportunity to students for extracurricular activities by organizing student week, photography competition and various societies etc. These activities help students to uplift their performances.

The Virtual University of Pakistan holds a Federal Charter, making its degrees recognized and accepted all over the country as well as overseas.

### **Content for Video:**

- I. Mode of Education in VU
- II. Student-teacher Interaction
- III. What is semester system?
- IV. VU Video Lectures
- V. VU Lectures Schedule

- VI. VU Mission
- VII. VU Open Courseware
- VIII. VU social media

#### I. Mode of Education in VU

The Virtual University uses a combination of video lectures, reading material, audio/video tutorials and on-line interaction (e-class rooms) for imparting knowledge. However, it follows a very formal assessment and evaluation system in the same fashion as used in any conventional higher education institution (HEI). Around 200 campuses of the University across Pakistan provide its students a great opportunity to participate in academic activities. Although, the University observes the semester system, its students have complete flexibility to study at their own convenience, pace and place.

VU campuses across the country provide its students a great opportunity to participate in academic activities without any extra burden on their pockets as compared with those studying at home. The wide spread of virtual campuses and complete flexibility to study at home jointly support the unique idea of “World Class Education at Your Doorstep” and in a true sense makes it unnecessary for students to relocate or travel to larger cities to obtain higher education.

The university's video lectures are developed by highly qualified faculty members or field experts in a complete digital environment and handcrafted at its own fully equipped recording studios. These lectures are then delivered through Virtual University's Learning Management System (VU-LMS) and its four free to air Television Channels (VTV1-4). Lectures are also made available over the Internet on YouTube, Dailymotion and the Virtual University's Open-Courseware site (<http://ocw.vu.edu.pk>). Although, the students can watch these video lectures at their own convenience, however the University suggests a “Time Plan” for guidance and better time management for studies during the semester. Students may also obtain the video lectures on DVDs from the University's online bookshop.

#### II. Student-teacher Interaction

Complete student-teacher interaction and support is provided through the VULMS while semester examinations are conducted in a formal, proctored environment at designated examination centers throughout the country.

#### III. What is semester system?

A semester system generally consists of two 16-week terms: one in the fall (followed by a winter break) and one in the spring (followed by a summer break). In annual system, exams are conducted after one educationalist year, while in semester system; exams are conducted after five or six months. Semester system includes assignments, Mid-term exam and Final-term exam that you will attempt to pass the semester. You will be given assignments and quizzes during whole semester that you will submit in specified deadline. All activities such as assignments and quizzes in VU will be announced at least one week before commencement.



#### IV. VU Video Lectures

To view lectures at any time of your convenience, you can visit <http://www.youtube.com/vu>. The same link is available on the main VU website under VU Lecture Videos. Besides, you can obtain all VU courses on DVDs from the Virtual University's online bookshop at nominal cost from <https://bookshop.vu.edu.pk/>. You can also watch Online VU TV Channels VTV-1, VTV-2, VTV-3 and VTV-4. These channels can be viewed on cable as well as dish receiver.

#### V. VU Lectures Schedule

- You can view lecture Schedule from virtual university's website ([www.vu.edu.pk](http://www.vu.edu.pk)) under **Student** link. The lecture schedule for different channels will be available there.

#### VI. Mission

- To provide the highest quality of education and research opportunities to all aspiring students irrespective of their age, gender, religion, and geographical location by using modern ICT with content developed by top experts of their respective fields.
- To train students to grow in their professional lives and inculcate an entrepreneurial mindset with high ethical and moral standards to become a productive part of society.
- To provide the best working environment to faculty and staff to create a culture of research, innovation and cooperation.
- To promote the philosophy of knowledge sharing by providing free and unhindered access to all of its educational content.

#### VII. VU Open Courseware

The Virtual University of Pakistan has always been committed to education for all and has, from its very inception, pursued an open policy regarding its content. The course material has been made freely available through broadcast television, DVDs, YouTube and is extensively used by students and faculty members alike from other universities, both formally and informally. To further this commitment, VU has now published all courses on its open courseware site (<https://ocw.vu.edu.pk/>), and thereby joined ranks with the top few universities of the world.

#### VIII. VU Social Media

- To get latest news you can follow official pages of vu at Facebook and Twitter.

### **Lesson 4: VU-Learning Management System**

VU-LMS is an abbreviation for Virtual University Learning Management System. This is the most important platform for student-teacher interaction. VU-LMS is a comprehensive software platform that allows students to manage their educational activities while studying at the university. Students can access it through Internet from any part of the world.

#### **Content for Video:**

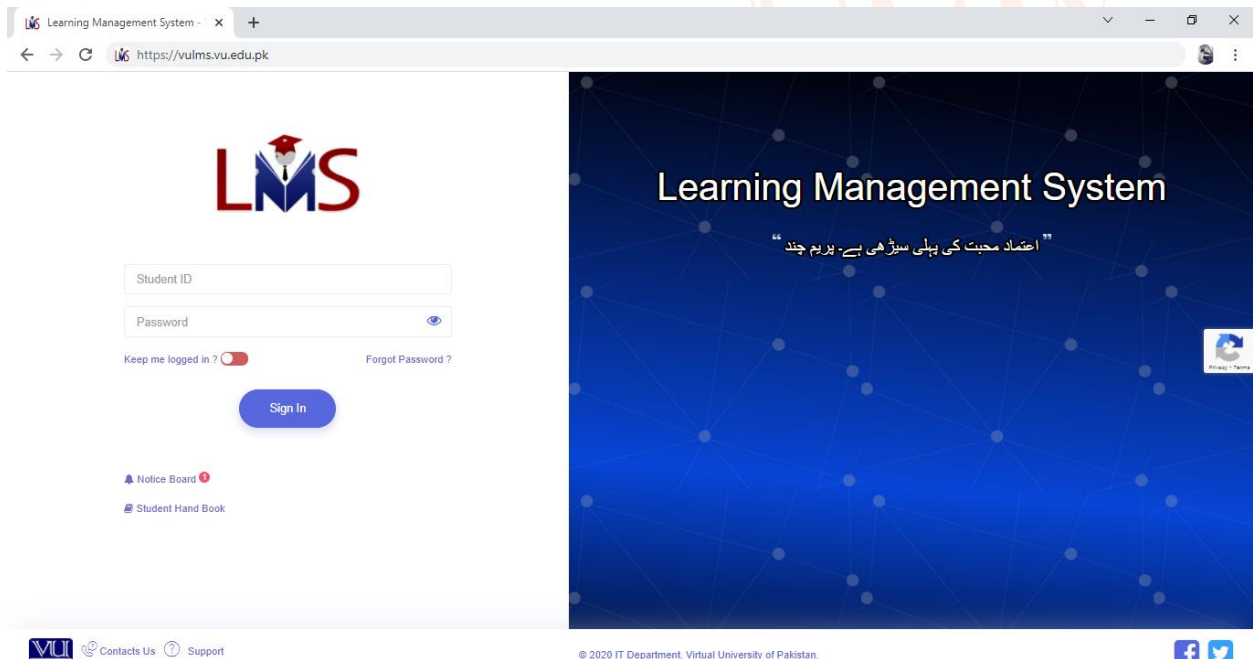
#### **Maha Malik's Compilation**

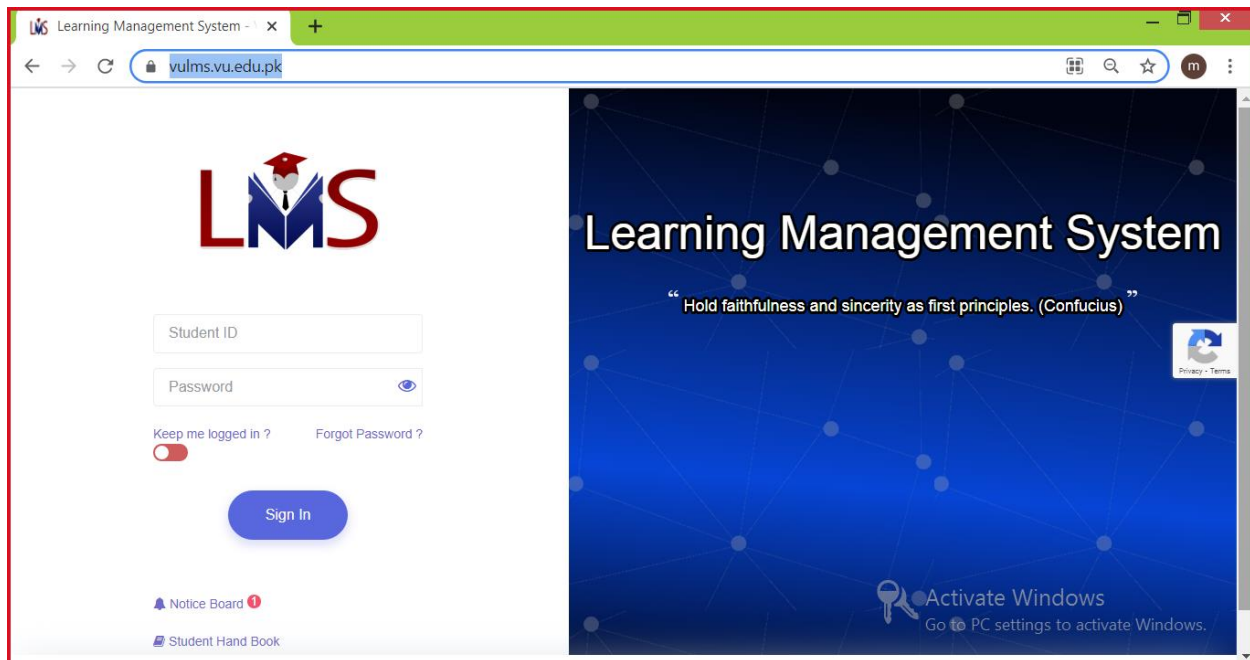
- I. How to access VU-LMS?
- II. Introduction to VU-LMS Interface
- III. Assignment Submission
- IV. Graded Discussion Board (GDB)
- V. Quiz Section
- VI. Various Links

## How to access VU-LMS?

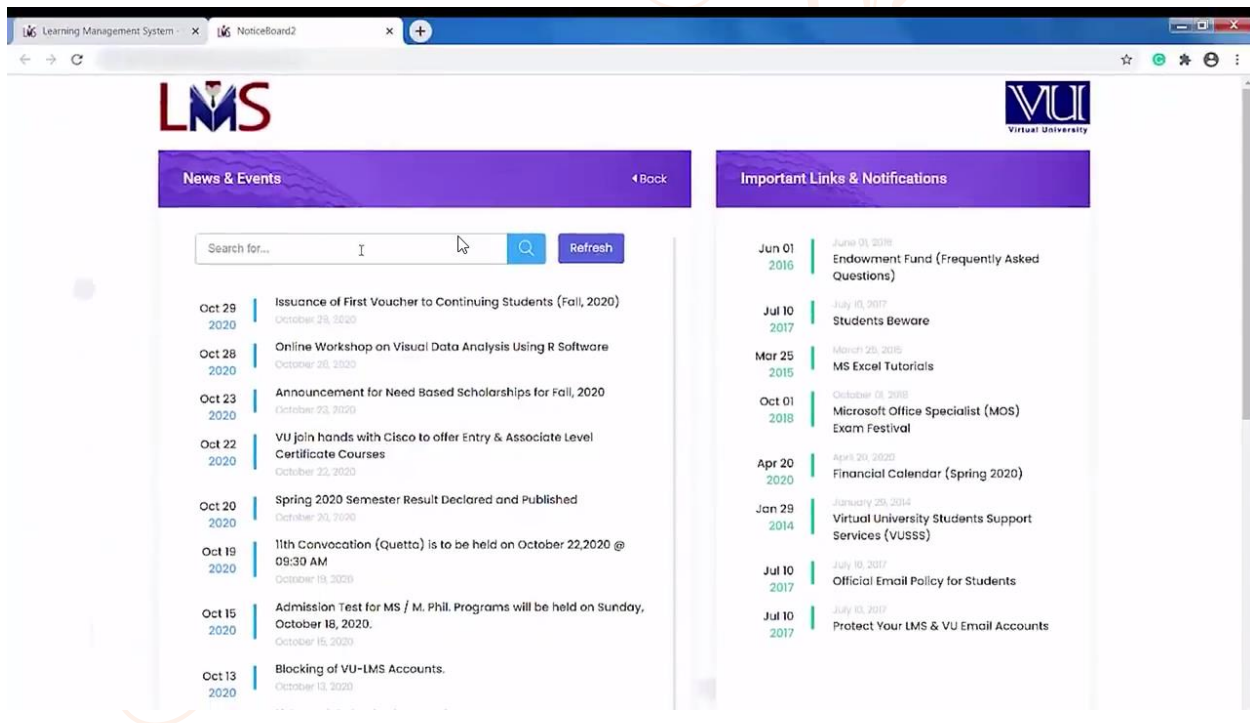
Type vulms.vu.edu.pk in address bar of your web browser and press enter to open the website.

The first page of the website contains the text fields of “Student ID”, “Password” and “Sign In button”. Besides, this page also contains some additional links such as Keep me logged in, Forgot Password, Notice Board and Student Handbook.





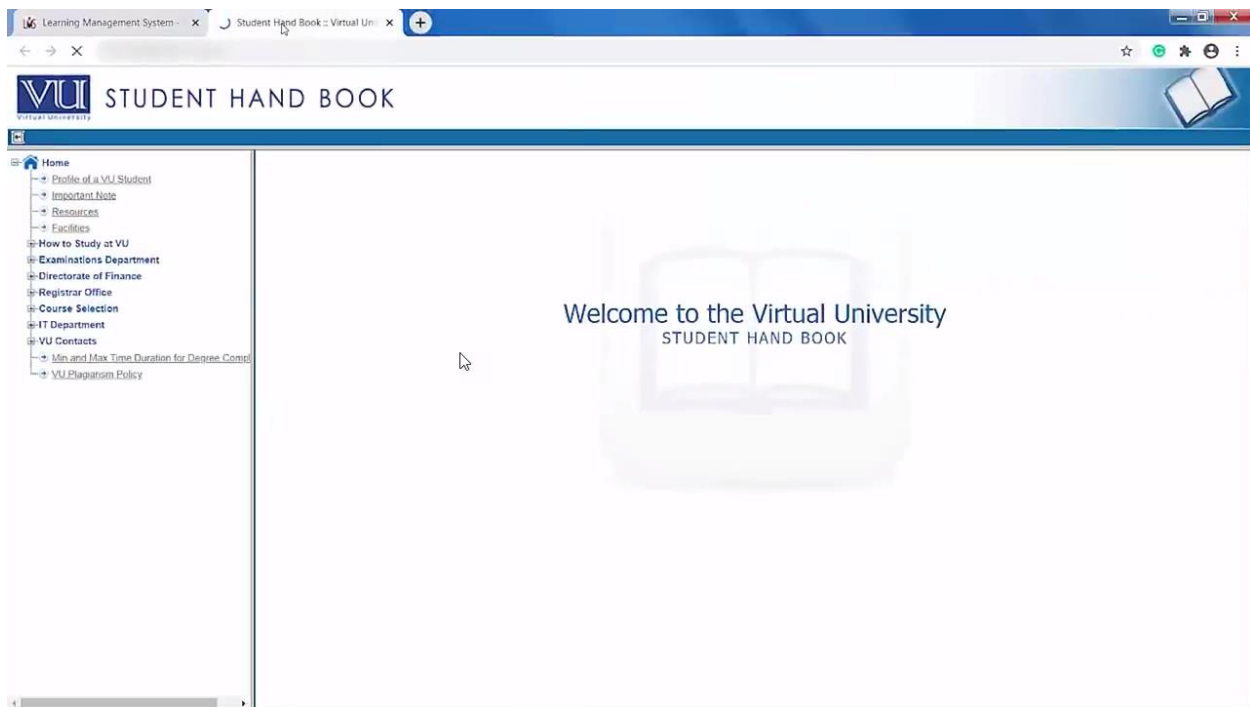
Upon Clicking on Notice Board Link, you will see the following screen:



This page contains news and events along with the important links and notifications sections.

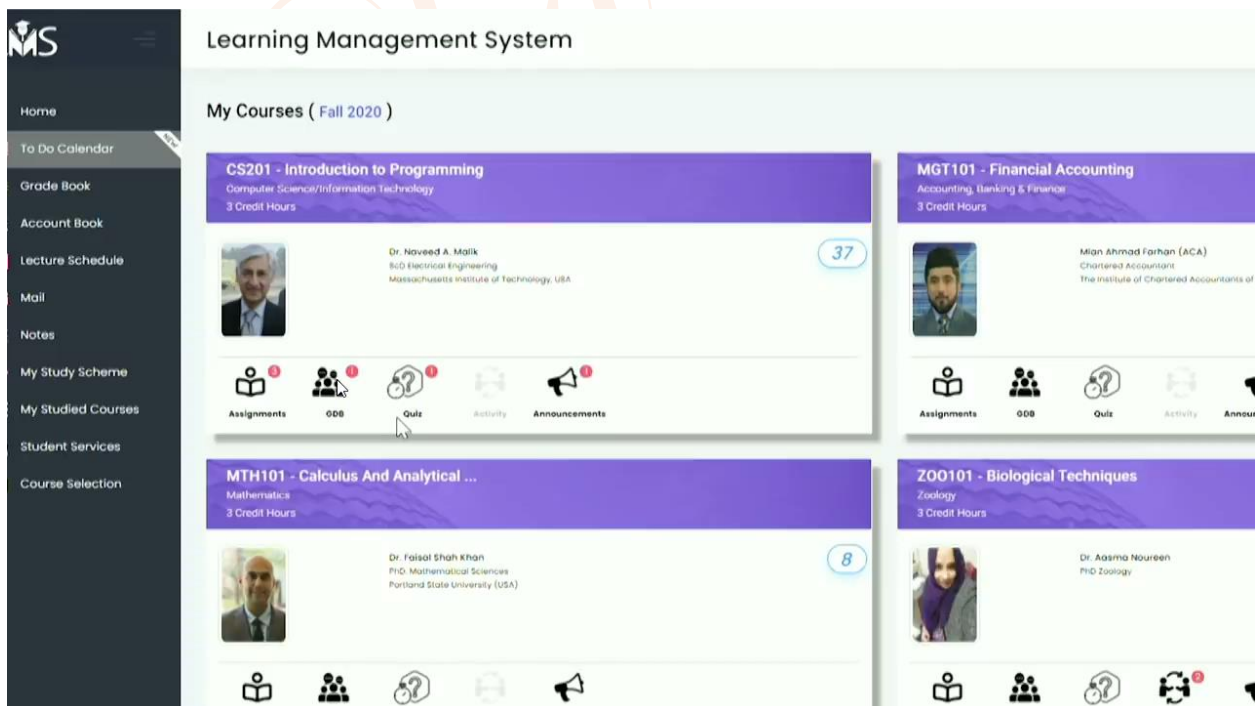
Student Handbook link will navigate you to the useful material for students.

**Maha Malik's Compilation**



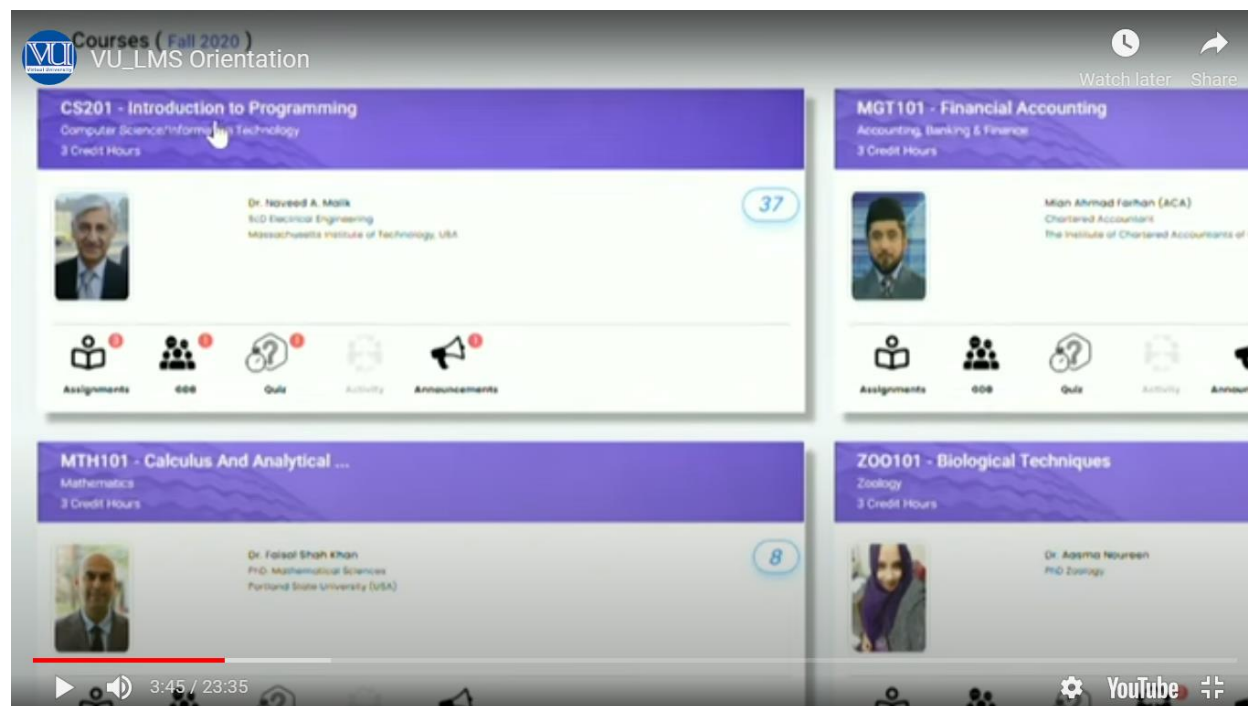
## Introduction to VU-LMS Interface

After entering your student ID and Password you get signed in to the VU-LMS.



This home page contains the student personal information along with the enrolled courses of current semester.

You can click on the respective course title for which you want to view the lesson videos.



Upon clicking on the course title, you will be navigated to the page where you will see the teacher profile, index lesson link and related links.

Index lesson link contains the course related lessons/videos, and the schedule of upcoming graded activities such as assignments, quizzes, GDB, Midterm and Final Term examinations etc. Click on any lesson link to open the lesson video. Reading tab containing all the lesson related content is also available. Moderated Discussion Board (MDB) is also available under this section using which students can ask queries to their respective course instructors. Students can use text, image and voice format options for sending messages through MDB.

Under the Index lesson link, there is "Course Information" link that contains course synopsis and its learning outcomes. Similarly, there are also other useful links available on the page such as FAQs, Glossary, Books, Download Files, Internet Links and Grading Scheme.



The screenshot displays a video player interface for a VU-LMS course. The video title is 'Introduction to Programming' and the instructor is Dr. Naveed A. Malik, ScD Electrical Engineering, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, USA. The video is titled 'VU-LMS Orientation' and is part of the 'Course Information' section. The course is 'CS201 Introduction to Programming', categorized under 'Computer Science/Information Technology' with '3 Credit Hours'. The 'Course Synopsis' describes the course's focus on C++ programming, covering basic concepts, pointers, arrays, and object-oriented programming. The 'Learning Outcomes' list includes: 'Analyze, design, and solve real world problems in C++', 'Understand the importance of modular program structure and reusability', 'Understand object oriented programming', and 'Understand the difference between procedural and object oriented paradigms'. The video player shows a progress bar at 4:47 / 23:35 and a YouTube logo.

## Assignment Submission

Assignment section in any course on VU-LMS is used by the teachers to upload assignments for students that are to be developed and submitted by the students on VU-LMS within the specified due dates.



Learning Management System  
VU\_LMS Orientation

CS201 - Introduction to Programming

Assignment Back

| # | Title                            | Assignment                       | Due Date     | Total Marks | Submit  | Result         | Discuss |
|---|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|-------------|---------|----------------|---------|
| 1 | Assignment 1                     | Assignment File<br>Solution File | Dec 01, 2020 | 20.00       | Expired | Result Remarks |         |
| 2 | Assignment 2                     | Assignment File                  | Feb 12, 2021 | 20.00       |         |                |         |
| 3 | Assignment 3                     | Assignment File                  | Feb 11, 2021 | 20.00       |         |                |         |
| 4 | Friends Function With Discussion | Assignment File                  | Feb 26, 2021 | 2.00        |         |                |         |

10:26 / 23:35

YouTube

Students can submit /upload their assignment solutions on VU-LMS by using submit button and following the related steps. On successful submission of assignment, a confirmation message “Assignment has been submitted successfully” will be displayed on screen. Assignment submission date will also be displayed on the screen. A student can download his / her submitted assignment by clicking the download button available on the screen.

Assignment

Learning Management System

CS201 - Introduction to Programming

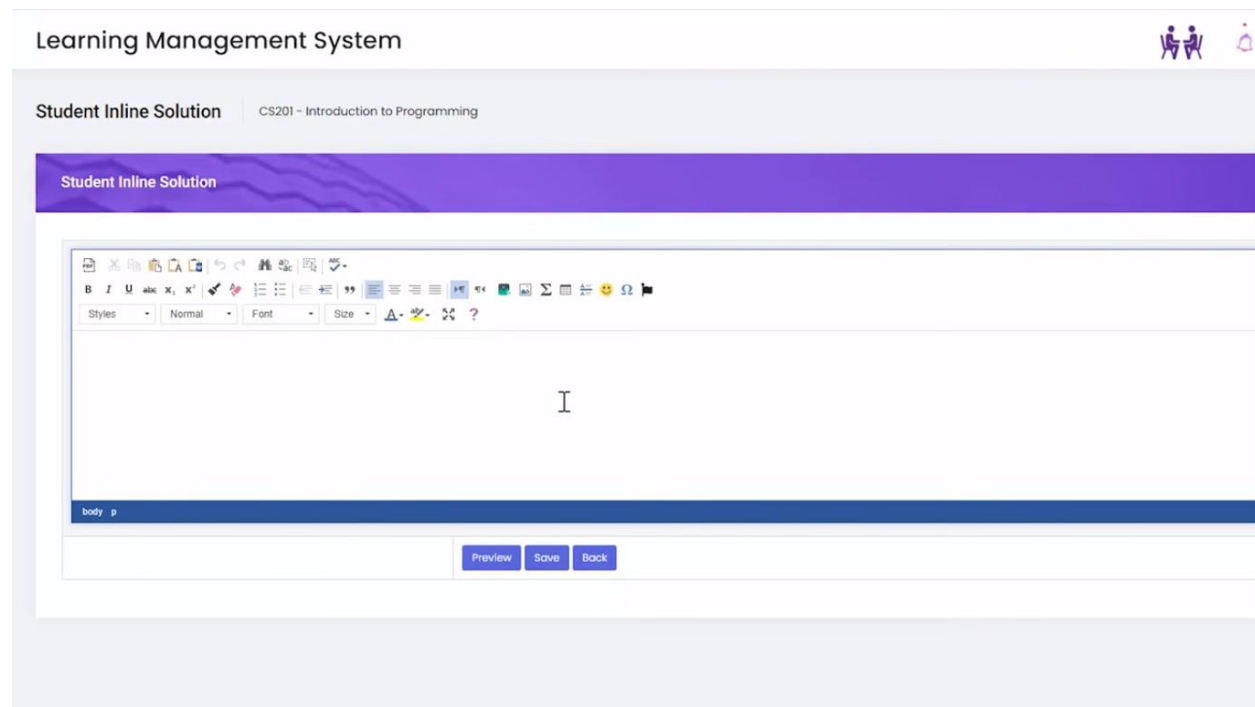
Assignment Back

| # | Title                            | Assignment                       | Due Date     | Total Marks | Submit  | Result         | Discuss |
|---|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------|-------------|---------|----------------|---------|
| 1 | Assignment 1                     | Assignment File<br>Solution File | Dec 01, 2020 | 20.00       | Expired | Result Remarks |         |
| 2 | Assignment 2                     | Assignment File                  | Feb 12, 2021 | 20.00       |         |                |         |
| 3 | Assignment 3                     | Assignment File                  | Feb 11, 2021 | 20.00       |         |                |         |
| 4 | Friends Function With Discussion | Assignment File                  | Feb 26, 2021 | 2.00        |         |                |         |

Fall 2020\_CS201\_...docx

Show all

A new feature has been introduced in “Assignment section” which enables the instructor to give such an assignment to students that needs to be submitted by the students on VU-LMS using a text editor available on VU-LMS called as inline assignment.



### **Graded Discussion Board (GDB)**

There is an interface “Graded Discussion Board (GDB)” through which the instructors give topic/scenario to students. In order to see the details of the topic/scenario given by the instructor, students can click on the “View” link and can submit their opinions/comments/solutions using “post message” link within the specified deadline.



## Graded Discussion Board (GDB)

[◀ Back](#)

| # | Question/ Description         | Total Marks | Start Date   | End Date     | Status | View GDB             | Result |
|---|-------------------------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|--------|----------------------|--------|
| 1 | Graded Discussion Board Topic | 5           | Feb 08, 2021 | Feb 11, 2021 | Open   | <a href="#">View</a> |        |



Total Marks: 5  
Starting Date: Monday, February 08, 2021  
Closing Date: Thursday, February 11, 2021  
Status: **Open**  
Question Title: Graded Discussion Board Topic  
Question Description:

## Graded Discussion Board Topic

Translators are software which is required to convert code written in high level language to machine code to make it understandable for computers. There are different translators used with different computer languages such as compiler, assembler and interpreters.

C++ is a compiler based language which translates the whole program at once on the other hand interpreter translates high level language to machine language line by line. In your opinion if we change the compiler of C++ and use an interpreter instead for this purpose, how will it affect C++ language in terms of processing speed, efficiency or other factors? Support your answer with solid points.

## GDB Instructions

1. You need to provide precise and to the point answer, avoid irrelevant details.
2. Material that is copied from the internet or another student will get zero marks.
3. You cannot participate in the discussion after the due date via email.
4. The GDB will open and close on specified date and time. Please note that **NO** grace day or extra time will be given for posting comments on GDB.

Post Message

Page Size: 10

[Show My Message](#)

Sort Order: Post Date Descending

No record found.

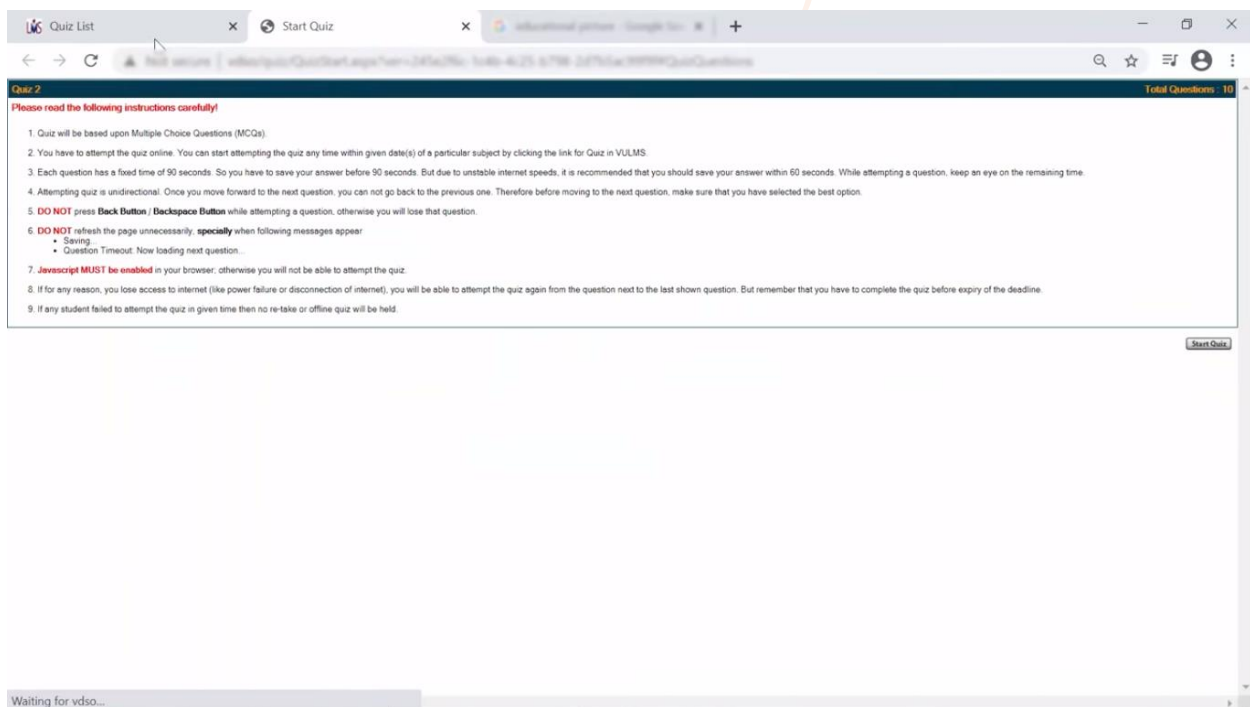
[Back](#)

## Quiz Section:

This interface contains all the information regarding the quiz(s) such as quiz title, start and end dates, total marks, quiz status (open / closed), submission status (submitted /not submitted) and result. The students have to submit the quizzes within prescribed deadline.

| # | Quiz Title | Start Date               | End Date                 | Total Marks | Quiz Status | Submit Status             | Result      |
|---|------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------|---------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Grand Quiz | Dec 31, 2020<br>12:00 AM | Dec 31, 2020<br>11:59 PM | 30          | Closed      | Not Submitted             | Un-Declared |
| 2 | Quiz 1     | Jan 21, 2021<br>12:00 AM | Jan 22, 2021<br>11:59 PM | 10          | Closed      | Not Submitted             | Un-Declared |
| 3 | Quiz 2     | Feb 08, 2021<br>12:00 AM | Feb 11, 2021<br>11:59 PM | 10          | Open        | <a href="#">Take Quiz</a> |             |

In order to submit a quiz, students can click on the “**Take Quiz**” link. On doing so, a new window containing the instructions regarding quiz will be opened.



After carefully reading the quiz instructions, students can start the quiz by clicking on “Start Quiz” button.

Quiz List Quiz

http://www.educational-technologies.com/quiz/question.aspx?quizid=1&questionid=1&start=115826&end=115916

QUEST: Answer All

CS201 Quiz 2

Time Left: 90 sec(s)

Quiz Start Time: 11:58 AM, 11 February 2021

Question # 1 of 10 (Start time: 11:58:26 AM, 11 February 2021)

reference is a thing by which we can create \_\_\_\_\_ of any data type.

Total Marks: 1

Select the correct option

☐ copy

☐ Synonym

☐ Pointer

☐ None of the given

Click to Save Answer & Move to Next Question

Waiting for video...

Quizzes are based on multiple choice questions where specific time slot (about 90 seconds) is reserved for each question. Students have to select the most suitable / appropriate option from the given and click the “Click to save Answer & Move to Next Questions” button. Students cannot go back to same question, once it has been attempted by the student.

Once you have attempted all the questions in a quiz, a message “Quiz Finished Successfully” will be appeared.

### Activity Section

In this section, students are informed about the schedule of the workshops of their respective campuses. Students can sign up for any available slot as per their ease.

If students are unable to participate in their scheduled activity (workshop) due to any reasons, then they can leave the activity within due date.

### Announcement Section

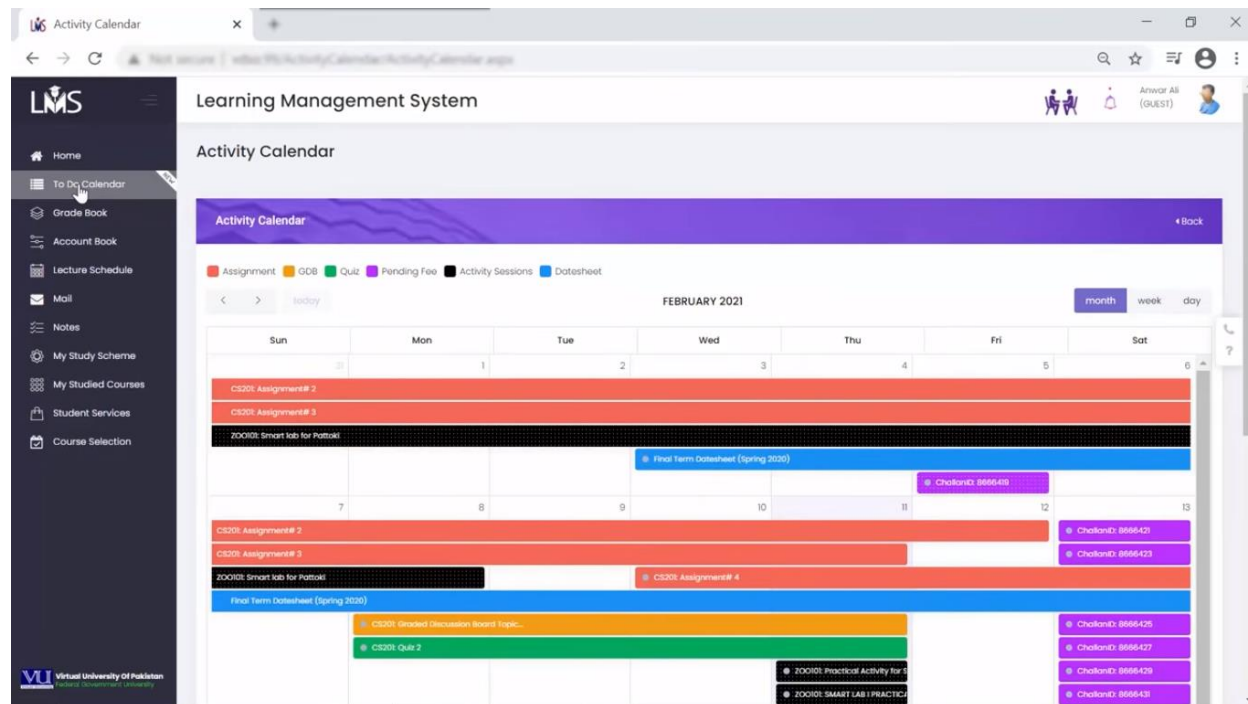
Course related announcements are made in this section for the students. Teachers keep updating their students about any upcoming course activities through this section.

Students can navigate to announcements of the course by clicking the “Previous” and “Next” buttons.

### To Do Calendar

Students are informed about their upcoming graded activities such as assignments, GDB, quizzes, date sheet alerts, workshops as well as pending fee of students through “To Do Calendar”.

Dotted activities in the “To Do Calendar” show that the dead line of such activities has expired.



## Grade Book

This is very important section. By using this section, students can view the results of their current and previous semester courses. Students can see semester CGPA, accumulative CGPA, collective CGPA and result detail of enrolled courses.



## Grade Book

Student Grade Book

Midterm Result (FALL 2020)

Grading Scheme

Projected CGPA Calculator

COUM/DAC

Name Anwar Ali

S/O Kamran Ali

Credits Exempted 0

0 Course(s)

Semester CGPA 0.00

Student ID GUEST

012-VU-555559

Credits Earned 30

10 Course(s)

CGPA 3.41/4.0

Study Program MBA

Master of Business  
Administration (2 year  
program)

Total Credits 72

Effective CGPA 3.41/4.0

| Semester    | Course | Title                    | Grade Point | Grade | Equivalent Percentage |
|-------------|--------|--------------------------|-------------|-------|-----------------------|
| Fall 2013   | ECO402 | Microeconomics           | 3.21        | B     | 73.57                 |
| Fall 2013   | MGT211 | Introduction To Business | 3.62        | B+    | 79.41                 |
| Fall 2013   | MGT301 | Principles of Marketing  | 3.69        | A-    | 80.44                 |
| Spring 2014 | ACC501 | Business Finance         | 3.05        | B     | 71.71                 |

## Account Book

Challan details issued from the university to the students are given in the account book section. Total number of challans issued to the student, total amount of challans and their due dates are mentioned here. Student(s) can submit their fee challans in the bank or submit it online using the same interface. Students can also submit their fee through HBL easypaisa, NADRS e sahoalat and FINCA Bank.

Account Book

Learning Management System

My Account Book

| Challan No. | Payable | Paid | Balance | Date                                     | Payment Mode | Cancelled | Action       |
|-------------|---------|------|---------|------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------|--------------|
| 2047775     | 500     | 0    | -500    | Due Date: Paid Date: Unpaid              |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 2047776     | 500     | 0    | -1000   | Due Date: Paid Date: Unpaid              |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 4707959     | 2000    | 0    | -3000   | Due Date: Dec 18, 2014 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362112     | 1500    | 0    | -4500   | Due Date: May 10, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362114     | 1500    | 0    | -6000   | Due Date: May 12, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362116     | 1500    | 0    | -7500   | Due Date: May 12, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362118     | 1500    | 0    | -9000   | Due Date: May 12, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362120     | 3000    | 0    | -12000  | Due Date: May 27, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362128     | 3000    | 0    | -15000  | Due Date: May 28, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362177     | 1500    | 0    | -16500  | Due Date: Jul 08, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |
| 5362179     | 1500    | 0    | -18000  | Due Date: Jul 09, 2016 Paid Date: Unpaid |              |           | Print Pay Up |

## Lecture Schedule

Students can see the weekly schedule of their enrolled courses through this link.

Weekly Lecture Schedule

Learning Management System

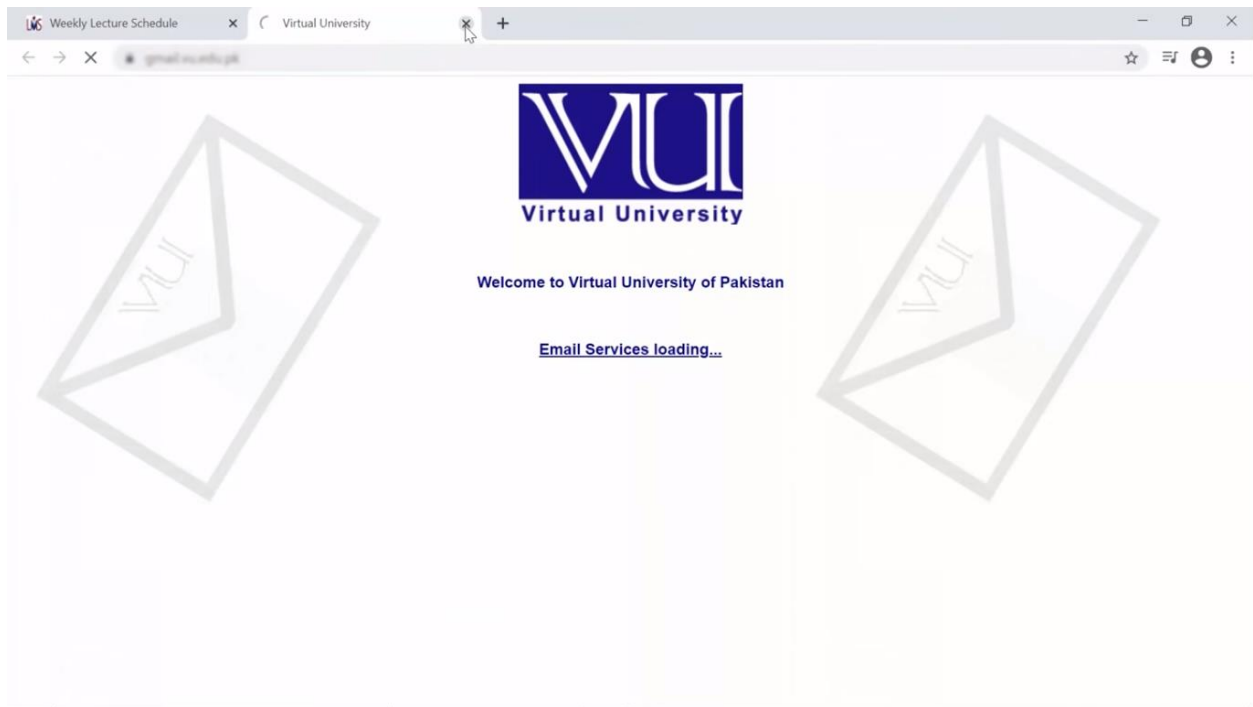
Weekly Lecture Schedule

| Time     | Mon 02/08                | Tue 02/09                  | Wed 02/10               | Thu 02/11                | Fri 02/12                | Sat 02/13                |
|----------|--------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| 09:00 AM |                          |                            |                         |                          |                          |                          |
| 10:00 AM |                          | CS201 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-1    |                         |                          |                          | MGT101 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-1 |
| 11:00 AM | MTH101 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-1 |                            |                         |                          | MGT101 - Lec 8<br>VUTV-2 |                          |
| 12:00 PM |                          |                            |                         |                          |                          |                          |
| 01:00 PM |                          |                            |                         | MGT101 - Lec 7<br>VUTV-2 |                          |                          |
| 02:00 PM |                          | MTH101 - Lec 9<br>CDROOM-2 |                         |                          |                          | MGT101 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-2 |
| 03:00 PM |                          |                            |                         |                          |                          |                          |
| 04:00 PM |                          | MTH101 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-1   |                         |                          |                          |                          |
| 05:00 PM |                          |                            |                         |                          |                          |                          |
| 06:00 PM |                          |                            | CS201 - Lec 9<br>VUTV-1 | MGT101 - Lec 7<br>VUTV-2 |                          |                          |
| 07:00 PM |                          |                            |                         |                          |                          |                          |

## Mail

Maha Malik's Compilation

This link redirects the students to the email facility that is given by VU to all students. Using this facility, the students can communicate with their instructors and other concerned departments of the university.



### **My Study Scheme**

Detail of all the courses related to the Student degree that are to be studied is given here. Student's pass out courses and pending courses are also mentioned here. My Studied courses link is also present under the My Study scheme.



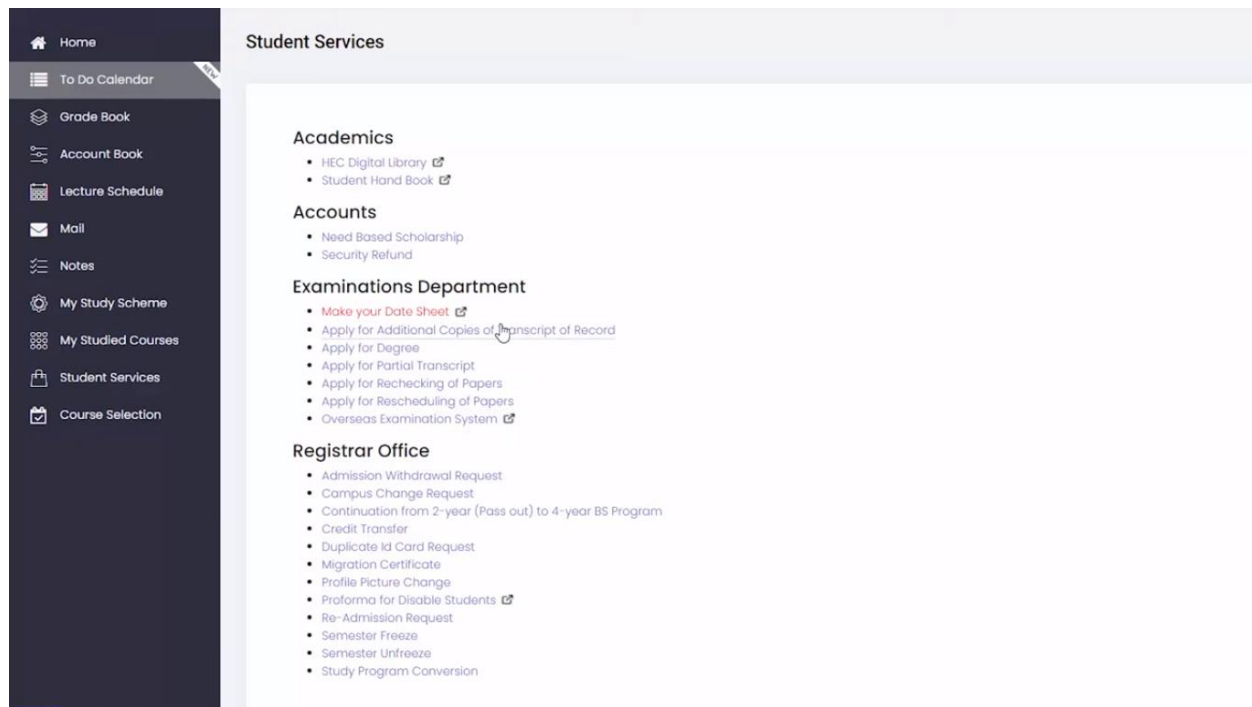
## My Study Scheme

| Degree        | Masters                           | Program  | MBA         | Version | Spring 2020 (0804) |                |         |
|---------------|-----------------------------------|----------|-------------|---------|--------------------|----------------|---------|
| Code          | Title                             | Type     | Course Type | Cr.Hrs. | Group              | Specialization | Status  |
| Semester No 1 |                                   |          |             |         |                    |                |         |
| CS101         | Introduction to Computing         | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Pending |
| MGT101        | Financial Accounting              | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Pending |
| MGT301        | Principles of Marketing           | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Studied |
| MGT501        | Human Resource Management         | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Pending |
| MGT503        | Principles of Management          | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Pending |
| MTH302        | Business Mathematics & Statistics | Required | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Pending |
| Semester No 2 |                                   |          |             |         |                    |                |         |
| ACC501        | Business Finance                  | Elective | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Studied |
| ACC501        | Business Finance                  | Elective | Regular     | 3       |                    |                | Studied |

## Student Services

There are 4 main heads under this section.

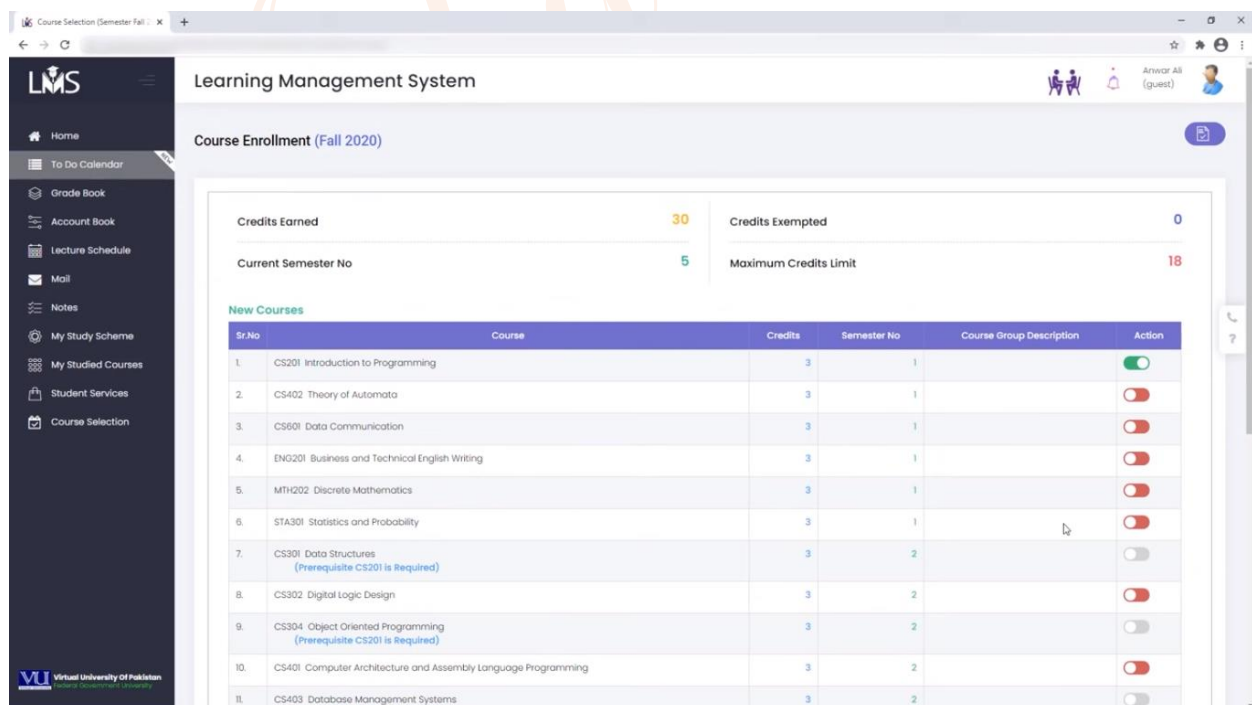
- Academics
- Accounts
- Examination Department
- Registrar Office



There are multiple links available under each of these heads. Students can get their requests/queries entertained/resolved using these links.

## Course Selection

Students can select their courses for the semester using this interface.



## Lesson 5: VU Support System

The support system is a web-based support system developed for the students and different departments of the University to better manage the request/queries received from the students. The support system also helps to reduce the overhead of receiving and tracking of bulk/irrelevant emails.

This guide describes the student's interaction with the support system for the resolution of different queries with different sections of the University.

### **Ticket**

A ticket is a query/request posted by the student through the Support System. When a ticket is created, its default status will be pending. The status will be changed from pending to close when it will be replied to by the staff members. The ticket can be rejected by the staff member in case of an irrelevant query or for any other reason.

### **VU and Other (non-VU) Students**

A support system is available for both VU and Other students. VU students will log in to the support system through their VULMS Login credentials while other students will have to sign up at the support system.

### **How to log into your Support System account**

- Open Virtual University Learning Management system VULMS (<https://vulms.vu.edu.pk/>).
- Click on Help icon to open the support system (<https://www.vu.edu.pk/SupportSystem>).
- Other (non-VU) user can use the link given in the VU Website **Contact US** Page to post his/her query.



**Learning Management System**

**COVID-19 Vaccination**

**COVID-19 Vaccination** [Back](#)

**Are you vaccinated?** ☒ Yes ☐ No  
Please choose "Yes", even if you have received single dose.

**First Dose** ☒ 26-Jun-2021

**Second Dose** ☒ 29-Jul-2021

**Vaccine Name** Sinovac (CoronaVac)

**Vaccination Certificate** [Choose File](#) No file chosen [e.g pdf, jpg, jpeg, png, bmp](#)

[How to get COVID Vaccination NADRA Certificate?](#)

[Submit Request](#)

**Help**

- VU Student will select VU Student option to login with their VULMS Login credentials

**Choose an account type to login**

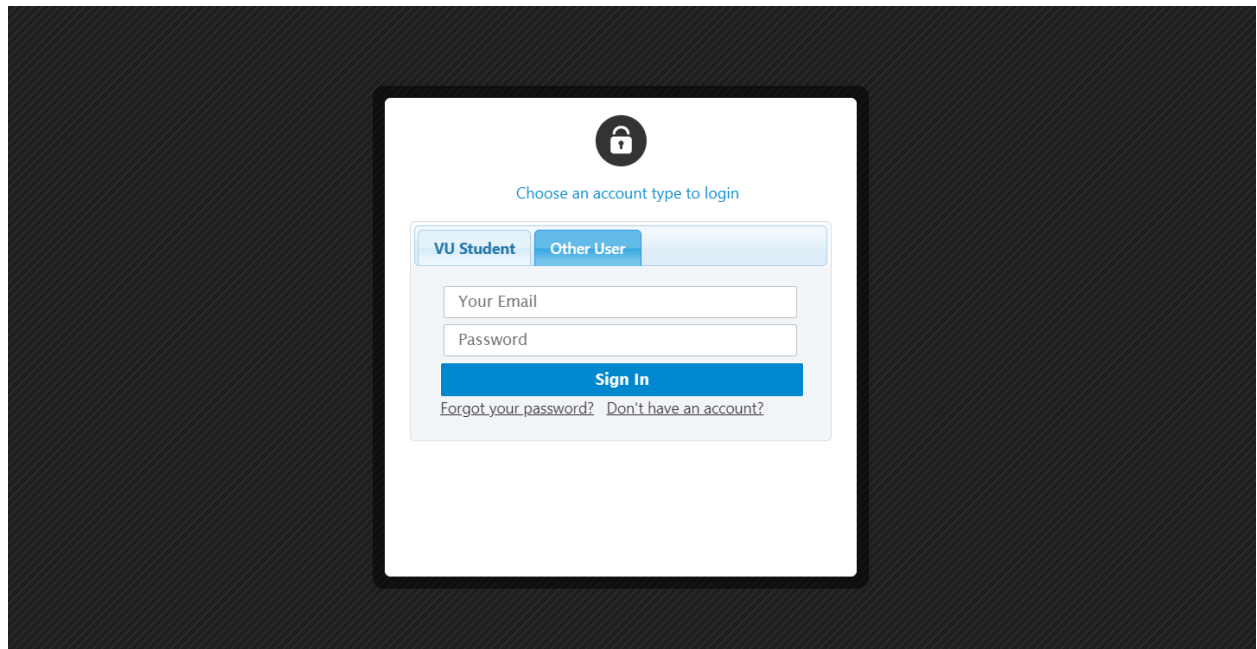
**VU Student** **Other User**

Student ID

Password

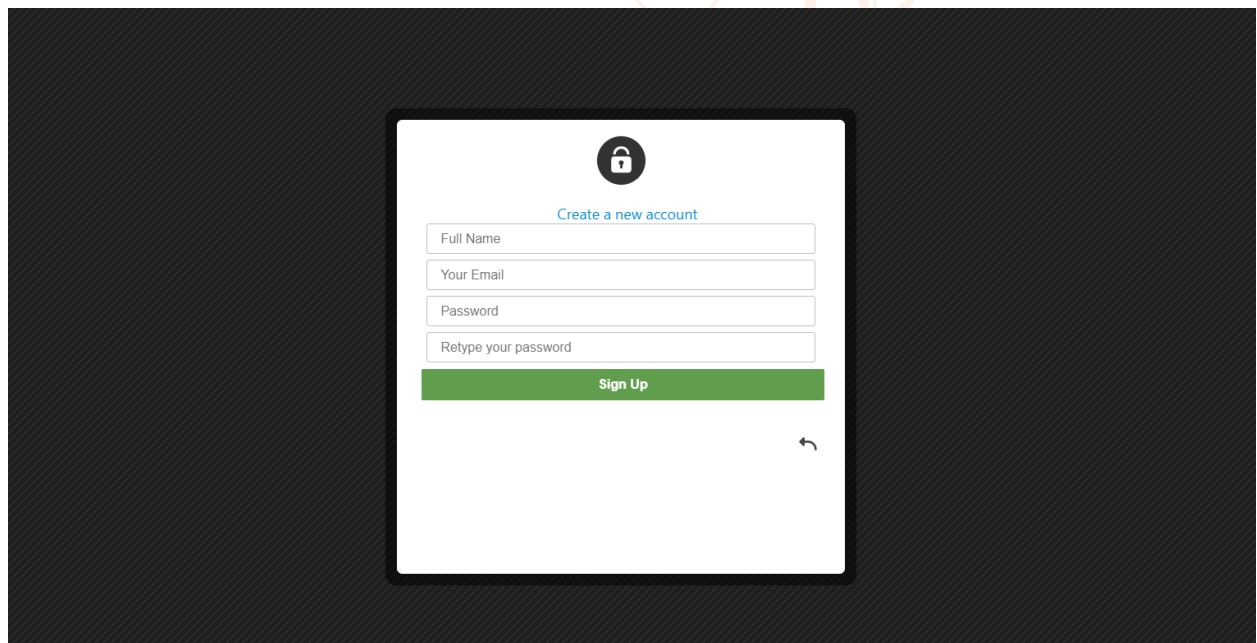
**Sign In**

- Other user (non-VU) will provide the registered email address and password to logon into the system.



The login form is centered on a dark gray background. It features a white card with a black border. At the top of the card is a black padlock icon. Below the icon, the text "Choose an account type to login" is displayed in a small, blue font. There are two tabs: "VU Student" (selected, highlighted in light blue) and "Other User" (unselected, highlighted in light gray). Below the tabs are two input fields: "Your Email" and "Password". A blue "Sign In" button is positioned below the input fields. At the bottom of the card, there are two links: "Forgot your password?" and "Don't have an account?".

- If the student is not a VU Student, he/she will have to get registered through the sign-up process

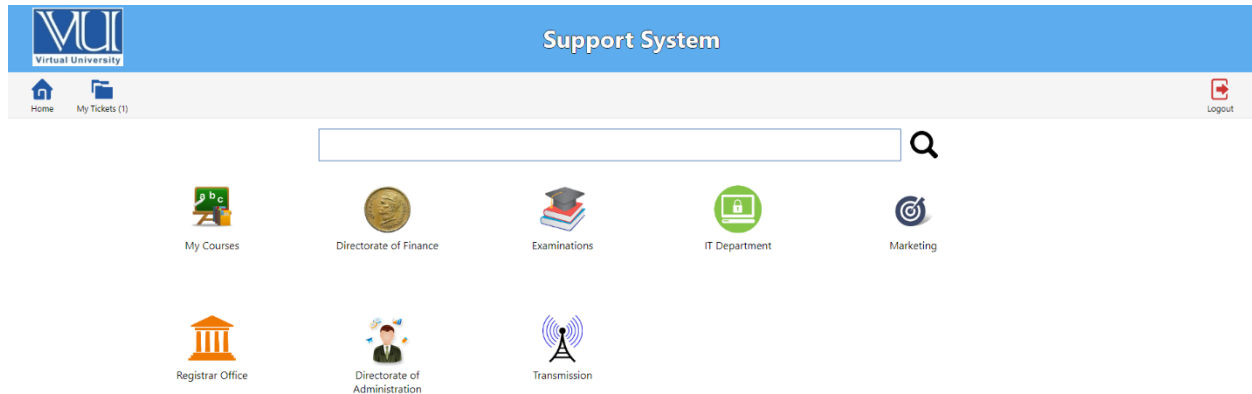


The sign-up form is centered on a dark gray background. It features a white card with a black border. At the top of the card is a black padlock icon. Below the icon, the text "Create a new account" is displayed in a small, blue font. There are four input fields: "Full Name", "Your Email", "Password", and "Retype your password". A green "Sign Up" button is positioned below the input fields. A small, curved arrow icon is located at the bottom right of the card.

**Home Page (After Login)**

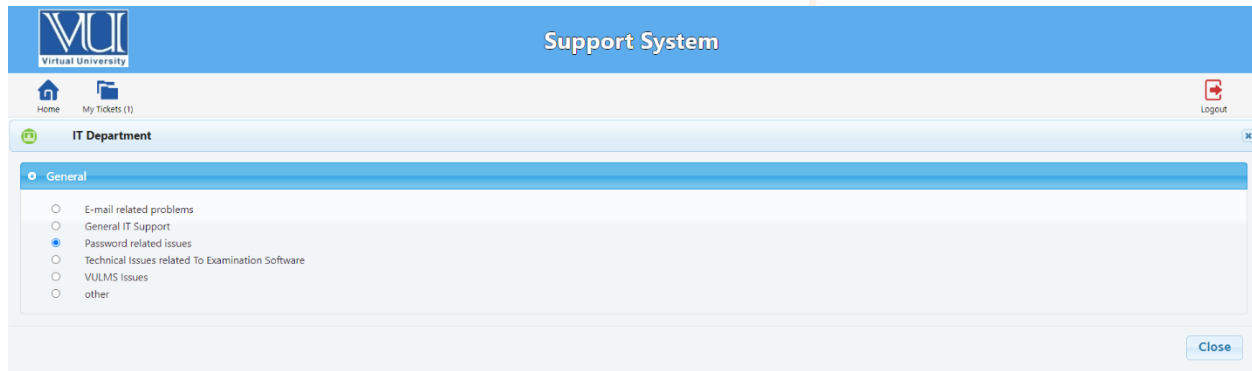
**Maha Malik's Compilation**

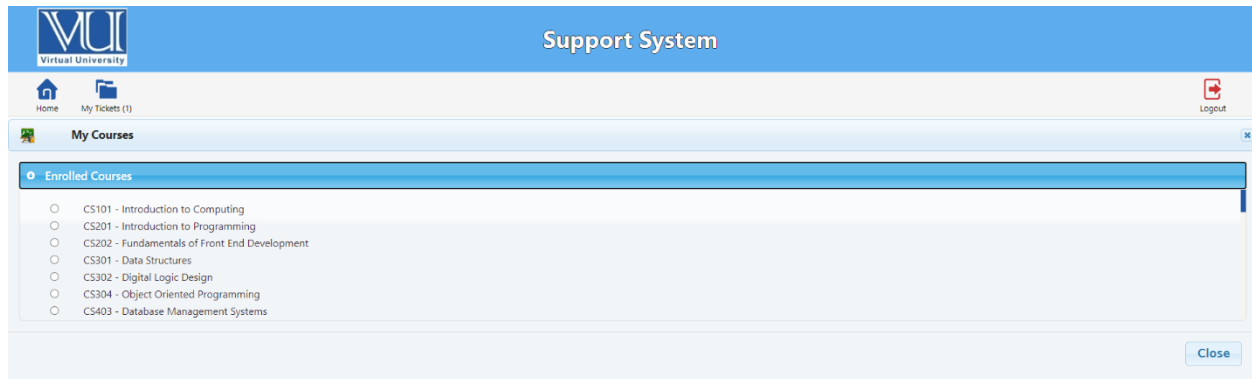
- After successful login, Student can post query related to his/her enrolled courses through My C



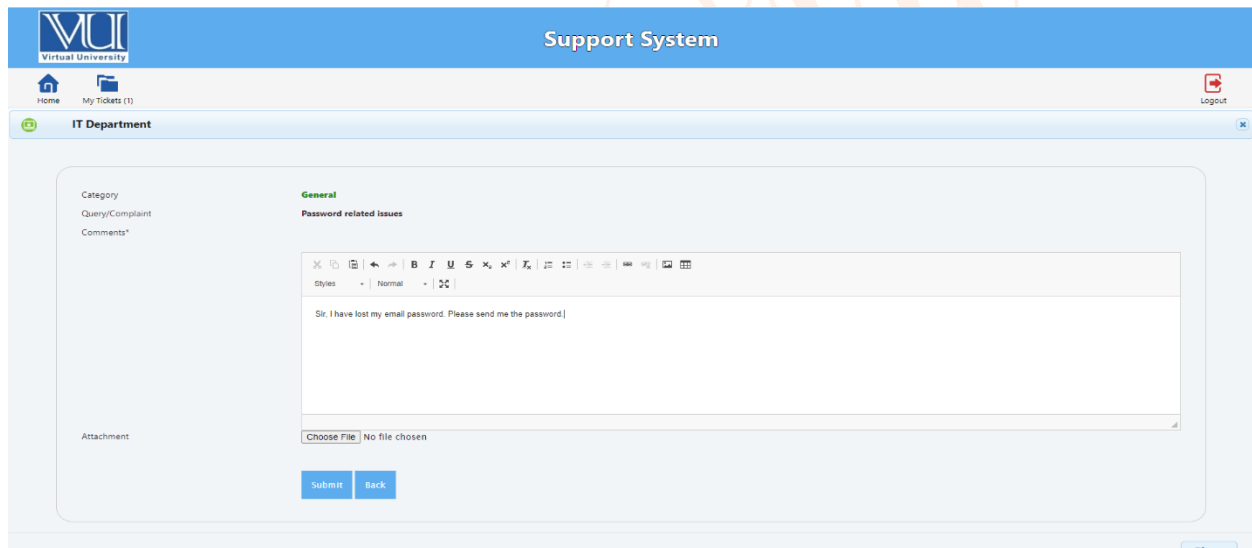
## Create Ticket

- When student clicks on any Department/My Courses, a popup with services details will be app





- Clicking on the respective section will open a pop up, student will enter his/her query and submit the respective section.



## My Tickets

Student will view their ticket listing and details through My Tickets section.

| Ticket ID | Category            | Query / Complaint                 | Create Date            |
|-----------|---------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------|
| 308       | Enrolled Courses    | CS101 - Introduction to Computing | 10/16/2020 11:39:45 AM |
| 295       | Admissions          | Faculty of Science and Technology | 8/5/2020 11:02:23 AM   |
| 294       | Admissions          | Faculty of Science and Technology | 8/5/2020 10:57:32 AM   |
| 293       | General             | Password related issues           | 8/5/2020 10:53:50 AM   |
| 292       | General             | other                             | 8/5/2020 10:53:35 AM   |
| 291       | Admissions          | Faculty of Science and Technology | 8/5/2020 9:52:43 AM    |
| 290       | General             | VULMS Issues                      | 7/30/2020 12:32:40 PM  |
| 286       | Fee matters, Others | Procedure to submit fee           | 7/27/2020 10:08:23 AM  |
| 283       | Admissions          | Faculty of Science and Technology | 4/15/2020 9:47:36 PM   |

## Ticket Detail

- Ticket details will be shown upon clicking the specific ticket.

Ticket ID: 290



Khalid Rehman (mc160400110)

Status: Pending

From: Khalid Rehman (mc160400110)

To: VULMS Issues-General

**vulms is not working :**

Attachment : [Click Here](#)

Posted on: 30/07/2020 12:32:40 PM

- Student can also reply to the ticket for which any additional information is acquired by the University staff.


**Virtual University of Pakistan**

 Home
  My Tickets (0)
  Logout

**Ticket ID: 294**
Posted on: 05/08/2020 10:58:08 AM

**Information Required**  
**From:** Faculty of Science and Technology-Admissions  
**To:** Khalid Rehman (mc160400110)  
 not information giving

**Reply To**  
 Faculty of Science and Technology-Admissions  
 Reply Message\*
 

Styles
 Format
 **B** *I* U **S** **X** **X** **I** **X**

Attachment
 Choose File No file chosen
 Submit Reply

**Attachment :** N/A

**Status:** : Information Required  
**From:** Khalid Rehman (mc160400110)  
**To:** Faculty of Science and Technology-Admissions  
 qaqa  
**Attachment :** N/A
 Posted on: 05/08/2020 10:57:32 AM


 +92 (42) 111 880 880 (ext): 242  

 Khalid Rehman (mc160400110)

## Lesson 6: Student Handbook

The student handbook gives a detailed overview of policies along with other key procedures and guidelines for students. The students are advised to study the Student Handbook so that they may get themselves familiarized with the university rules and regulations / procedures.

### Content for Video:

- I. Profile of a VU Student
- II. Important Note
- III. Resources
- IV. Facilities
- V. How to Study at VU
- VI. Examinations Department
- VII. Directorate of Finance
- VIII. Registrar Office
- IX. Course Selection
- X. IT Department

## **Maha Malik's Compilation**



- XI. VU Contacts
- XII. Min and Max Time Duration for Degree Completion
- XIII. VU Plagiarism Policy

I. Profile of a VU Student

Successful Virtual University students:

- take responsibility for their own learning
- are self-motivated and self-disciplined
- understand that “online” is a far more convenient way to learn
- are comfortable and confident with written communications
- are willing to be members of an online community
- are open minded about sharing life, work, and educational experiences as part of the learning process
- are always willing and open to acquiring new skills
- are willing to "speak up" if problems arise
- think ideas through thoroughly, before sharing them with others
- actively and appropriately participate in class discussions
- complete and turn in assignments on time
- use time and resources efficiently and stay focused on the task at hand
- approach each day with a positive attitude
- treat others with respect and courtesy, even online
- accept others and their points of view
- maintain healthy professional relationships among their peers
- cooperate and work well with others, especially in cyber-space
- believe in collaboration and healthy competition
- demonstrate good character in helping and encouraging others
- use polite and acceptable language when communicating
- are expected to demonstrate the highest levels of honesty and integrity
- build mutually supportive relationships that assist them in pursuing their goals and dreams
- become life-long learners
- find valuable lessons from everything they experience
- are willing to commit the required amount of time to their studies
- are critical thinkers and reflective practitioners
- believe that high-quality learning can happen anywhere, anytime
- are active, creative and engaged in the learning process.

II. Important Note

In the Internet age, it is critically important to understand that any information that you send electronically or place on a remote web-site (or even on a computer at a public place) may be accessed by other individuals regardless of whether you allow them to do so or not. In this context, please keep the following guidelines in mind all the time:

- You should never share your password with anyone. Doing so may divulge your personal information that you may not have wanted to share
- Your login ID and password are also the custodians of your academic efforts. Allowing access to your work may enable an unscrupulous individual to copy your work and claim it as his/her own. The University has a zero-tolerance policy on copying and plagiarism and all participants in such activity will get a zero grade as a minimum
- You will be personally held responsible for all actions performed through your e-mail or LMS accounts, since both of these are password protected and only you are supposed to know your password.

### III. Resources

All resources mentioned below may be accessed from the Virtual University homepage <http://www.vu.edu.pk> under “Quick Links”

#### VU Lecture Videos (YouTube)

You can view all VU lecture videos on YouTube directly or at <http://www.youtube.com/vu> .

#### HEC Digital Library

The [HEC digital library](#) has a host of journals, articles and publications that can assist you in learning.

#### MIT Open Courseware

The [MIT Open Courseware](#) is an extremely valuable repository of learning resources provided by the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) USA.

### IV. Facilities

#### Campus Career Portal

VU has a Career Development Office for the placement of its graduates. This is done through the campus career portal which is powered by Rozee.pk under a National ICT R&D Fund, initiative of the Ministry of Information Technology. Access it by clicking on the [Campus Career Portal](#) link on VU homepage under “Quick Links”.

#### On-line Bookshop

You may place orders for lecture handouts & DVDs through the [Bookshop](#) link on the VU homepage.

#### Virtual Campuses

The university has established campuses across the length and breadth of Pakistan to facilitate its students. The complete list of campuses can be accessed from the [VU homepage](#).

#### Broadcast Lecture Schedule

VU broadcasts video lectures through its four TV channels (VTV1, VTV2, VTV3, and VTV4). To help manage your time and streamline learning activities, the lecture schedule is provided to you through the “Lecture Schedule” button in the LMS.

#### DSL Broadband Internet Connectivity

DSL Broadband Internet Connectivity is available at subsidised rates to VU students.

#### VU Email

VU provides students with their own individual email accounts for which the required username and password are provided by the University in the admission letter. VU email (powered by Google) can be accessed at <http://gmail.vu.edu.pk/>

#### Campus-based/home-based Study Option

Students have the option to study at a campus or from home.

#### VU-CPL (Computer Proficiency License)

Basic Computer and Internet skills are the need of the day and are especially crucial for pursuing any course of study at VU effectively. The Virtual University has developed a complete set of interactive modules for this purpose, collectively known as VU-CPL. These audio/video modules, which are based on a self-learning paradigm, do not require a teacher for acquiring these skills. VU-CPL is available as a two DVD set from the [VU Bookshop](#).

#### Scholarships

From time to time various scholarships are provided to VU students. Keep visiting/checking the Scholarships link on the [VU homepage](#).

#### Cable Operators

A list of cable operators, who carry some or all of the VU TV channels, is available from the [VU homepage](#).

### V. How to Study at VU

1. Getting Started
2. How to Take Lectures
3. How to Do Assignments
4. Email Etiquette
5. Plagiarism Sensitisation

## VI. Examinations Department

- Conduct of Examination
  1. Examination Date Sheet Sign-Up
  2. Code of Conduct for Examinations within Pakistan
  3. Code of Conduct for Examinations outside Pakistan
  4. Re-Examination
  5. Cancellation of Examination
  6. Rescheduling of Examinations
- Unfair Means / Misbehavior / Violation of Examinations Regulations
  1. Acts of Unfair Means
  2. Acts of Misbehavior
  3. Acts of Violation of Examinations Regulations
  4. Plagiarism Policy for Answer Scripts
  5. Processing of Unfair Means / Misbehavior / Violation of Examinations Regulations Cases
  6. Right to Appeal and Review of Appeal
- Result
  1. Re-Checking of Paper(s)
  2. Merit Positions
  3. Gold Medals
- Issuance of Documents
  1. Final Transcript
  2. Additional Copies of Transcript of Record
  3. Partial Transcript
  4. Degree
  5. Urgent Degree
  6. Duplicate Degree
  7. Diploma
  8. Certificate
  9. Convocation

10. Verification of Document

VII. Directorate of Finance

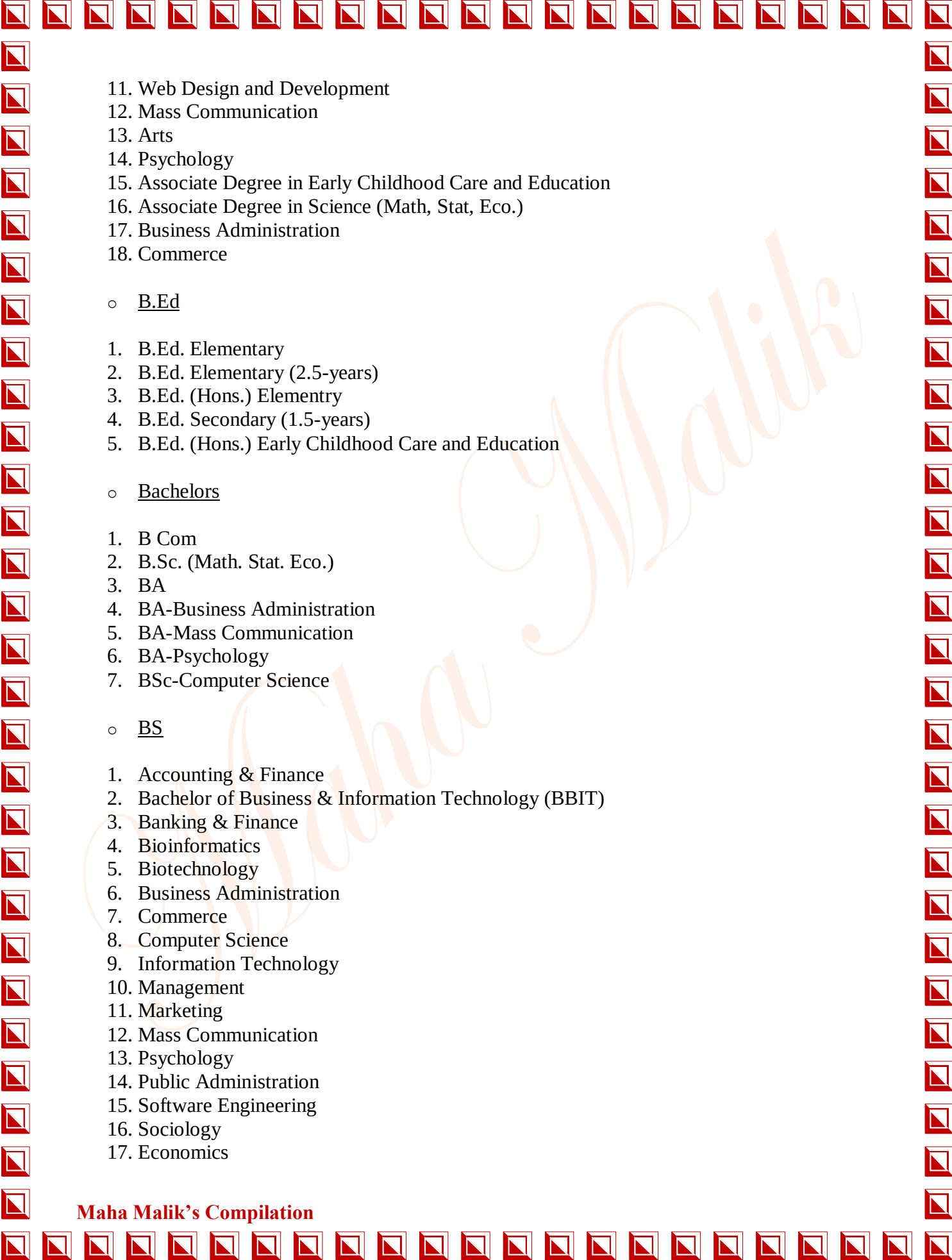
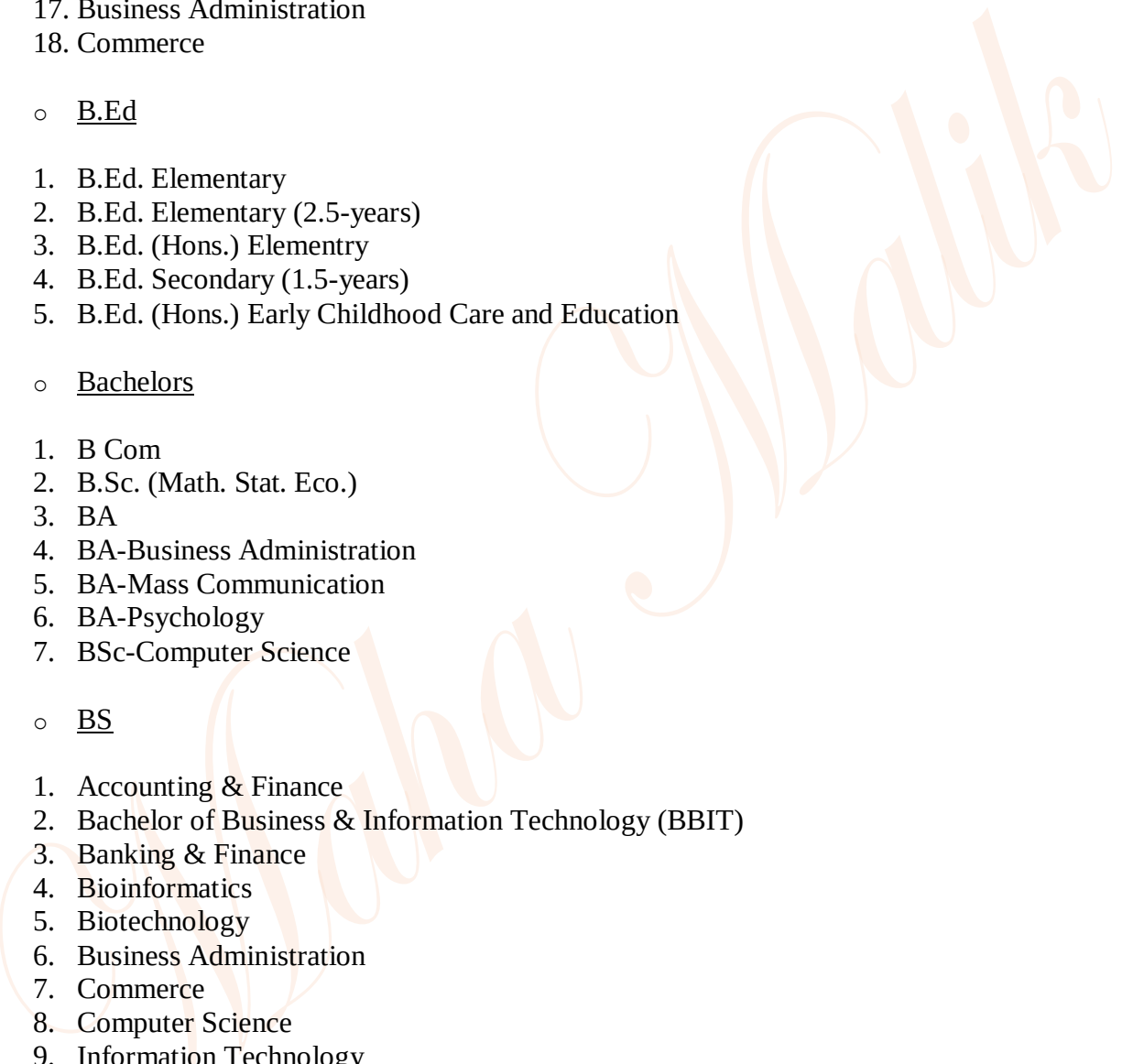
1. Fee Structure for Local Students
2. Fee Structure for Overseas Students
3. Schedule of other Charges
4. Merit based Scholarships
5. Need based Scholarships
6. Fee Concession for Disabled Students
7. SOP for Blocking
8. SOP for Installments of Full Semester Voucher
9. Adjustment of Unpaid dues from Security Refundable amount
10. Security Refund
11. Student Endowment Fund
12. Charging Semester Enrolment Fee + 1 Course Fee
13. Policy for Late Submission of Last Deliverable of Final Year Project
14. Endowment Fund (FAQs)
15. Fee Concession Scheme for the employees of Corporate Sector, HEC Islamabad & MoIT
16. Policy for Refund of Dues to the Deceased Students

VIII. Registrar Office

1. Semester Unfreeze
2. Semester Freeze
3. Campus Change Request
4. Re-Admission Request
5. Profile Picture Change
6. Admission Withdrawal Request
7. Procedure to apply for Course Exemption/Transfer
8. Student's Profile

IX. Course Selection

- Associate Degree Programs
  1. Accounting & Finance
  2. Education
  3. Human Resource Management
  4. Islamic Banking
  5. Operations Management
  6. Sales and Marketing
  7. Supply Chain Management
  8. Education (ADE) [In-service]
  9. Database Management System
  10. Computer Networking

- 
- 
11. Web Design and Development
  12. Mass Communication
  13. Arts
  14. Psychology
  15. Associate Degree in Early Childhood Care and Education
  16. Associate Degree in Science (Math, Stat, Eco.)
  17. Business Administration
  18. Commerce

- B.Ed

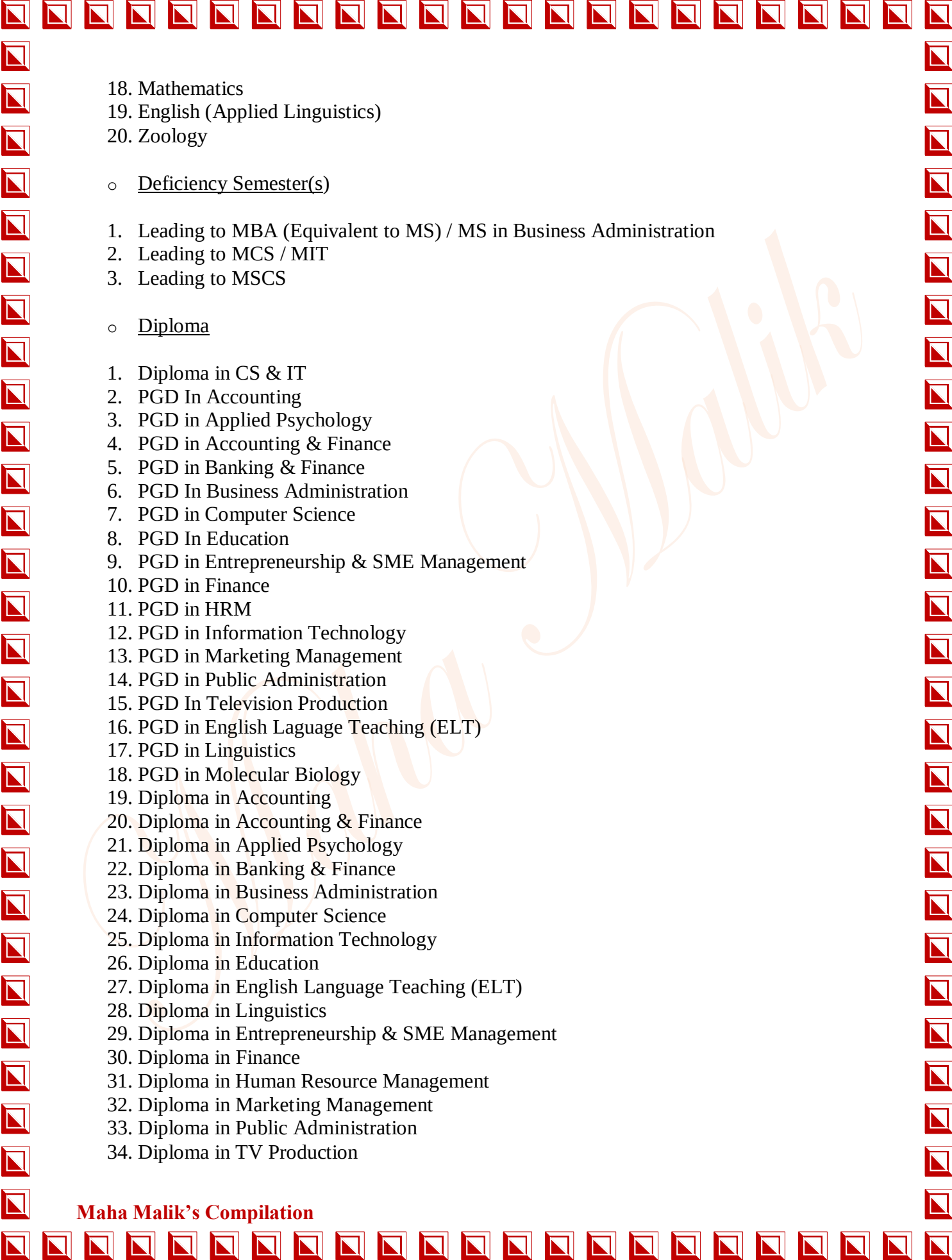
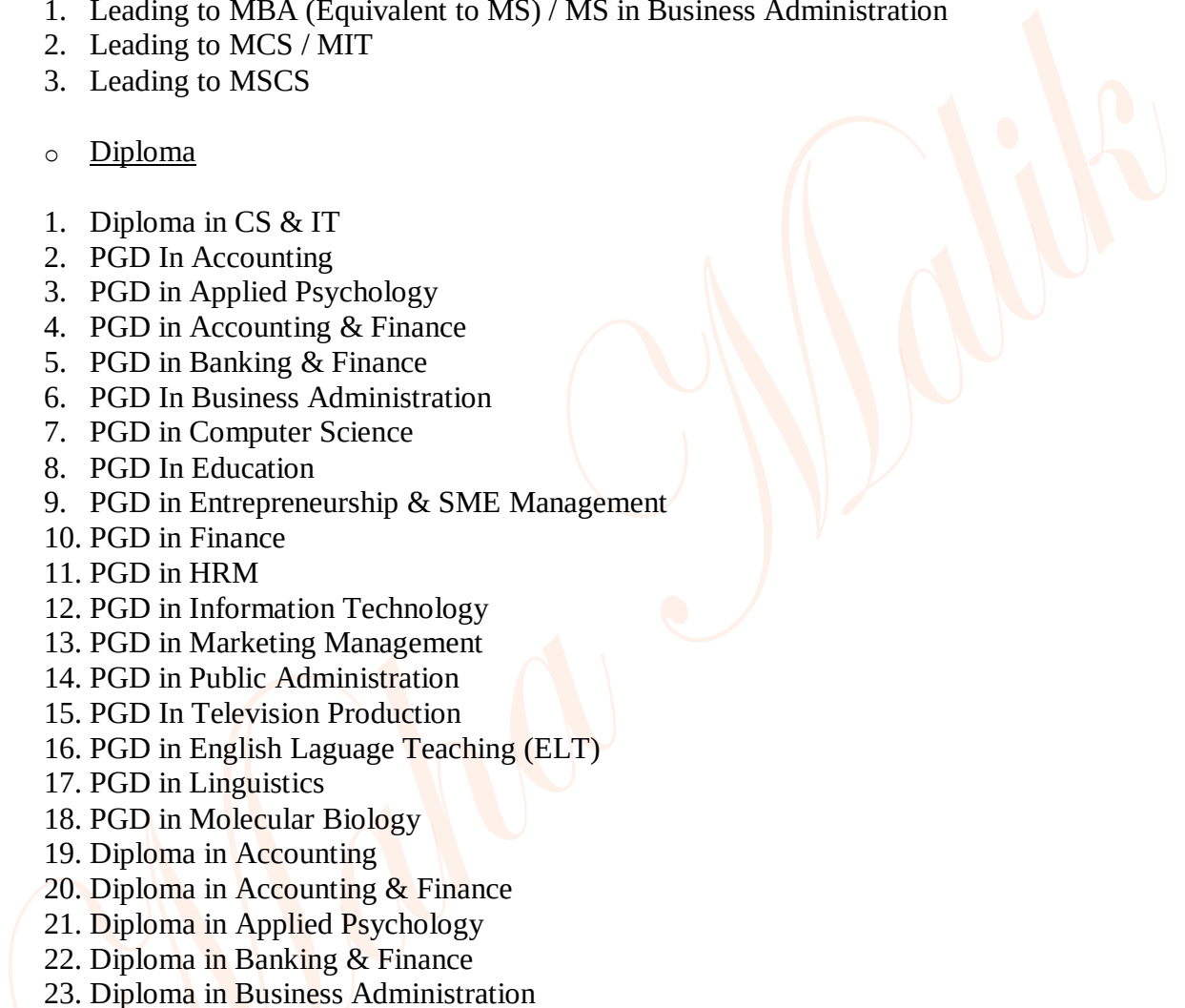
1. B.Ed. Elementary
2. B.Ed. Elementary (2.5-years)
3. B.Ed. (Hons.) Elementary
4. B.Ed. Secondary (1.5-years)
5. B.Ed. (Hons.) Early Childhood Care and Education

- Bachelors

1. B Com
2. B.Sc. (Math. Stat. Eco.)
3. BA
4. BA-Business Administration
5. BA-Mass Communication
6. BA-Psychology
7. BSc-Computer Science

- BS

1. Accounting & Finance
2. Bachelor of Business & Information Technology (BBIT)
3. Banking & Finance
4. Bioinformatics
5. Biotechnology
6. Business Administration
7. Commerce
8. Computer Science
9. Information Technology
10. Management
11. Marketing
12. Mass Communication
13. Psychology
14. Public Administration
15. Software Engineering
16. Sociology
17. Economics

- 
- 
18. Mathematics
  19. English (Applied Linguistics)
  20. Zoology

○ Deficiency Semester(s)

1. Leading to MBA (Equivalent to MS) / MS in Business Administration
2. Leading to MCS / MIT
3. Leading to MSCS

○ Diploma

1. Diploma in CS & IT
2. PGD In Accounting
3. PGD in Applied Psychology
4. PGD in Accounting & Finance
5. PGD in Banking & Finance
6. PGD In Business Administration
7. PGD in Computer Science
8. PGD In Education
9. PGD in Entrepreneurship & SME Management
10. PGD in Finance
11. PGD in HRM
12. PGD in Information Technology
13. PGD in Marketing Management
14. PGD in Public Administration
15. PGD In Television Production
16. PGD in English Language Teaching (ELT)
17. PGD in Linguistics
18. PGD in Molecular Biology
19. Diploma in Accounting
20. Diploma in Accounting & Finance
21. Diploma in Applied Psychology
22. Diploma in Banking & Finance
23. Diploma in Business Administration
24. Diploma in Computer Science
25. Diploma in Information Technology
26. Diploma in Education
27. Diploma in English Language Teaching (ELT)
28. Diploma in Linguistics
29. Diploma in Entrepreneurship & SME Management
30. Diploma in Finance
31. Diploma in Human Resource Management
32. Diploma in Marketing Management
33. Diploma in Public Administration
34. Diploma in TV Production



### 35. Diploma in Molecular Biology

#### ○ Masters

1. M. Accounting
2. M. Accounting & Finance
3. M. Banking & Finance
4. M. Finance
5. M. HRM
6. M. Operation & Supply Chain Management
7. M.Com
8. M. Economics
9. M.Sc. Mass Communication
10. MB Econ
11. MBA
12. MBA-Exec. (72 Cr. Hrs. / 2 Years)
13. MBS
14. MCS
15. MIT
16. MPA
17. M.Sc. Zoology
18. M.Sc. Applied Psychology
19. M.Sc. Organizational Psychology
20. M.Sc. Mathematics
21. M.Sc. Statistics
22. M.Ed Education
23. MA ELT

#### ○ MBA

1. MBA (36 Cr. Hrs. / 1.5 Years)
2. MBA (72 Cr. Hrs. / 2.5 Years)
3. MBA (96 Cr. Hrs. / 3.5 Years)

#### ○ MS

1. M.Phil in Education
2. MBA (Equiv. to MS 1.5 Year)
3. MS in Bioinformatics
4. MS in Biotechnology
5. MS in Business Administration (1.5 Year)
6. MS in Computer Science
7. MS in Genetics
8. MS in Zoology
9. MBA (Equ. to MS) 2-year Revised
10. MSBA (Master of Science Business Administration) 2-year Revised

- 11. MS in Molecular Biology
- 12. MS in Mathematics (Research Thesis / Course Work Track)

- Ph.D

- 1. Ph.D (Biotechnology)
- 2. Ph.D (CS)

X. IT Department

- 1. VU Email Deletion (Inactive Students)
- 2. VU Email Deletion (Withdrawn Students)
- 3. VU Email Deletion (Passout Students)

XI. VU Contacts

- 1. Contact Us
- 2. <https://www.vu.edu.pk/contact.aspx>

XII. Min and Max Time Duration for Degree Completion

**Minimum and Maximum Time Duration**

**for the completion of a Degree Program**

(w.e.f. Spring 2018 Semester)

The University has approved the following Minimum and Maximum Time Duration / Semesters for the Completion of a Degree Program:

| Sr. No. | Degree Level       | Minimum Duration      | Maximum Duration |
|---------|--------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| 1       | PhD                | 3 years / 6 semesters | 8 years          |
| 2       | MS/M.Phil.         | 2 years / 4 semesters | 4 years          |
| 3       | Master (M.A/M.Sc.) | 2 years / 4 semesters | 4 years          |
| 4       | BS (4-year)        | 4 years / 8 semesters | 8 years          |
| 5       | Bachelor (2-year)  | 2 years / 4 semesters | 4 years          |
| 6       | Associate Degree   | 2 years / 4 semesters | 4 years          |

**Note:**

- ☐ Maximum time duration includes semester freeze period.
- ☐ Minimum and maximum duration for the completion of Diploma, Deficiency Semester, Specialization Certification, Certificate Course and Zero Semester will remain same as per existing policy.

**XIII. VU Plagiarism Policy**

[https://handbook.vu.edu.pk/HandBook\\_Pages/VU%20Plagiarism%20Policy.pdf](https://handbook.vu.edu.pk/HandBook_Pages/VU%20Plagiarism%20Policy.pdf)

*You can view complete detail about each heading of hand book on following link:*

<https://handbook.vu.edu.pk/>

**Lesson 7: Writing a Query: Best Practices**

During study at Virtual University, if you feel something confusing, you may ask questions to the instructor through MDBs, email and support system to get answer during working hours. However, students are advised and expected to observe best practices while asking their queries. Let's watch a video tutorial in this regard.

**Content for Video:**

There are several key elements when communicating with your tutor/teacher for asking your queries in an online mode of education. Some of them are as follows;

**Elements of a Good Online Writing Style**

**Key Element:** Clarity

**Objective:** To communicate clearly

**Strategies:**

- Create single-subject messages whenever possible.
- Open the message text with a sentence that either:
  - Connects it to previous correspondence, or identifies its purpose.
- Focus on the subject and purpose.

- Arrange ideas in a logical sequence.

**Key Element:** Meaningful Subject

**Objective:** To stay on particular matter

**Strategies:**

- Think of meaningful but short titles.
- Should be relevant to the content
- Don't use single words like "Hi" or "Hello" or "Help".

**Key Element:** Readability

**Objective:** To make information accessible

**Strategies:**

- Use about 15 to 20 words per sentence.
- Limit each sentence to one idea.
- Use complex sentences of 25 to 35 words rarely as they require a high level of reading skill.
- Vary the length of sentences to add rhythm and interest to your writing.
- Use the active voice.
- Avoid slang.
- Remove ambiguous and unnecessary words.

**Key Element:** Positive language

**Objective:** To create a positive first impression

**Strategies:**

- Use direct and courteous language.
- Choose positive rather than negative words.

**Key Element:** Proper use of Grammar

**Objective:** To communicate clearly, the sentences must be grammatically correct.

**Strategies:**

- While writing a query, use proper:
  - subject
  - object
  - verb

- adverb
- noun
- pronoun

**Key Element:** Punctuation

**Objective:** To keep the meaning clear

**Strategies:**

- Start a sentence with a capital and end with a full stop.
- Check that the sentence is not too long.
- Separate ideas by using paragraphs.
- There should be proper use of commas and full stop in the sentences.

**Key Element:** Tone

**Objective:** To establish the communication climate

**Strategies:**

- Avoid emotional responses (called 'flaming').
- Use a courteous and tactful tone.
- Use an appropriate level of formality.

**Key Element:** Case (Capital/Small)

**Objective:**

To receive proper and desired response against your query

**Strategies:**

- Try not to send any text message in CAPITALS.
- Not write in all lower-case letters; follow formal style.

**Key Element:** Privacy

**Objective:** To avoid inconvenience

**Strategies:**

- Try not to disclose any information of others to anyone.
- Ask permission prior to giving out an email address or other information.

**Key Element:** Read before Send

**Maha Malik's Compilation**

**Objective:** To avoid misunderstandings

**Strategies:**

- Do a spell check (use the Check Spelling option).
- Double-check all writing to make sure that it clearly conveys the exact intended message.
- Read your text through the eyes of the recipient; it will help you send a more effective message and avoid misunderstandings and inappropriate comments.

**Key Element:** Send / Post your query to relevant department /receiver/ Instructor

**Objective:** To receive prompt and desired response

**Strategies:**

- Make sure to send /post your query to its relevant /intended receiver only.

**Key Element:** Wait for Reply

**Objective:** To get a reply of your asked query

**Strategies:**

- Wait for at least 24 Hours.
- Send a polite reminder if not get a reply after 24 Hours.

### **Lesson 8: Examination System**

Virtual University has developed computer-based E-Examination system which allow its students to prepare their personalized date sheet by giving them complete liberty to choose city, exam center, day, session and even the subject in which they intend to be examined during the mid and final term examinations. The system also facilitates the students to appear from overseas, in case of traveling abroad or vice versa. In other words, this unique and most flexible system is not less than a blessing especially for working students. Here is a video tutorial regarding VU examination system, let's watch it.

### **Rules & Regulations regarding the examination system**

- I. All rules and regulations related to Examinations are made available at a centralized place in Student Handbook on VULMS at the following link under "Examinations Department" node. The student may visit the following link of Student Handbook for the detailed information of Examination Regulations.

<https://handbook.vu.edu.pk/> -> Examinations Department

### **How to make a date sheet**

**Maha Malik's Compilation**

### **Rules:**

- I. Mid and Final Semester-Examination commencement dates are defined in Academic Calendar of each semester.
- II. The Date Sheet interface (<http://datesheet.vu.edu.pk>) given in VULMS shall be opened 25-30 days before the start of Examinations for a specific time.
- III. A student shall make his/her own Date Sheet, on a first come first served basis, for every Examination through Date sheet interface (<http://datesheet.vu.edu.pk>). However, University reserves the right to create the Date sheet for any or all students as deemed necessary.
- IV. A student shall make his/her own date sheet within the stipulated time.
- V. After the stipulated time, late fee shall be applicable as prescribed by the University.
- VI. A student is not allowed to appear in the Examinations without a Date sheet.

### **Procedure:**

- I. Log-in on date sheet interface (<http://datesheet.vu.edu.pk>) by using your VULMS Student ID and Password.
- II. Choose your Exam City in which you want to appear for the Exam (optional). Overseas students shall select 'OVERSEAS'.
- III. Choose your Exam Center from the given centers (Once selected, you can't change your Exam Center)
- IV. Select the available exam date and start time of your own choice for each of your courses, then click the "Confirm" button to confirm your selection.
- V. Repeat the Step-4 for all your remaining courses one by one.

### **How to conduct an online exam**

- I. The student is required to visit the following link for Demo of the VU Examination system. This Online Demo allows students to get themselves familiar with VU Examination Software and its available features. This will help students to attempt their paper conveniently under real time environment.

[http://qb.vu.edu.pk/Vutes\\_demo/Default.aspx](http://qb.vu.edu.pk/Vutes_demo/Default.aspx)

### **Lesson 9: Ethics of using Computers**

As technology advances, computers and the Internet have an increasing impact on society. Studying computer ethics helps us to know what is good and bad act of using computers and how to deal with the computer properly without hurting other people. For more, let's watch a video tutorial.

### **Content for Video:**

- I. What is term "Ethics"?
- II. What is "Computer Ethics"?



### III. 10 Commandments by Computer Ethics Institute

#### I. What is term "Ethics"?

- Ethics deals with placing a "value" on acts according to whether they are "good" or "bad".
- Every society has its rules about whether certain acts are ethical or not.
- These rules have been established as a result of consensus in society and are often written into laws.

#### II. What is "Computer Ethics"?

- When computers first began to be used in society at large, the absence of ethical standards about their use and related issues caused some problems.
- Today, many of these rules have been formulated as laws, either national or international.
- Computer crimes and computer fraud are now common terms.
- There are laws against them, and everyone is responsible for knowing what constitutes computer crime and computer fraud.

### III. 10 Commandments by Computer Ethics Institute

The 10 commandments of computer ethics have been defined by the Computer Ethics Institute. Here is our interpretation of them:

#### *1. You shall not use a computer to harm other people:*

- It is unethical to harm people by making a bomb,
  - For example, it is equally bad to write a program that handles the timing of the bomb. Or, to put it more simply, if it is bad to steal and destroy other people's books and notebooks, it is equally bad to access and destroy their files stored on computer.

#### *2. You shall not interfere with other people's computer work:*

- Computer viruses are small programs that disrupt other people's computer work by destroying their files, taking huge amounts of computer time or memory, or by simply displaying annoying messages.
- Generating and consciously spreading computer viruses are unethical.

#### *3. You shall not snoop around in other people's files:*

- Reading other people's e-mail messages is as bad as opening and reading their letters: This is invading their privacy.
- Obtaining other people's non-public files should be judged the same way as breaking into their rooms and stealing their documents.

#### *4. You shall not use a computer to steal:*

- Using a computer to break into the accounts of a company or a bank and transferring money should be judged the same way as robbery.
- It is illegal and there are strict laws against it.

*5. You shall not use a computer to bear false witness:*

- The Internet can spread untruth as fast as it can spread truth.
- Putting out false "information" to the world is bad.
- For instance, spreading false rumors about a person or false propaganda about historical events is wrong.

*6. You shall not use or copy software for which you have not paid:*

- Software is an intellectual product.
- In that way, it is like a book: Obtaining illegal copies of copyrighted software is as bad as photocopying a copyrighted book.
- There are laws against both.

*7. You shall not use other people's computer resources without authorization:*

- Multiuser systems use user ids and passwords to enforce their memory and time allocations, and to safeguard information.
- You should not try to bypass this authorization system.

*8. You shall not appropriate other people's intellectual output:*

- For example, the programs you write for the projects assigned to you in any course are your own intellectual output.
- Copying somebody else's program without proper authorization is software piracy and is unethical.
- Intellectual property is a form of ownership, and may be protected by copyright laws.

*9. You shall think about the social consequences of the program you write:*

- You have to think about computer issues in a more general social framework: Can the program you write be used in a way that is harmful to society?

**Lesson 10: Security Concerns at a Glance**

In this era of Internet, it is critically important to understand that any information that you send electronically or place on a remote web-site (or even on a computer at a public place) may be accessed / damaged / misused by other individuals regardless of whether you allow them to do so or not. There are so many security concerns associated with our computers and data. In this context, let's take a brief glance on such security concerns /threats in this video.

**Content for Video:**

- I. What is Computer Security?
- II. What are security concerns /thefts associated with computer and data?
- III. Protective Guidelines

I. What is Computer Security?

- Protecting a computer system and data stored in it from being damaged or accessed by unauthorized persons is called computer security.

II. Security Concerns/Thefts associated with computer and data:

Our computers can be accessed by un-authorized users in multiple ways. For example, if you don't have set credentials (login and password) on your computer then any un-authorized person can easily use your computer and data. In other case, if you have set the credentials for your computer even then your credentials can be hacked/ stolen by some un-authorized person to get the access of your computer as well as your important data if you are not following proper guidelines in this regard. Furthermore, your computers can be accessed by un-authorized persons through Internet.

Data can loss or be damaged by computer viruses (computer programs written with intention to harm/damage/steal, transfer the data stored in our computers to some other computers or to occupy the system resources such as memory which in turns deteriorates the overall performance of the computer. Such programs can take different forms and may enter into your system through different ways.

For example:

- By downloading and installing pirated software on your computer through an un-trusted website / pirated CDs/DVDs.
- By clicking on a link (available on an untrusted website or in the email from any untrusted /unknown sender) indicating:
  - Download / obtain gift, lottery, bonus, special offers.
  - To see your personal images.
  - To enter your bank account number, debit card / credit card numbers
  - To enter any other confidential information etc.
- By copying data from an affected portable device such as USB to your computer.

III. Protective Guidelines:

- It seems a very difficult task to keep track of all the security threats/concerns which are known to us, and the new ones that just keep emerging. The best thing we can all do is to properly follow the related guidelines. Here are some simple tips/guidelines that you can use to protect yourself from security threats:

1. **Use of passwords:**

1.
  - Protect your computer and data with password. Using secure passwords is the most important way to prevent from un-authorized access. The more secure your passwords are, the harder it is for a hacker (un-authorized individual) to access your system.
  - Use a password that has at least eight characters and a combination of numbers, uppercase and lowercase letters, and symbols.
  - Use unique passwords for each account and keep changing them regularly.
  - Do not share your login and password information with anyone in any case.
2. **Downloading and installing software**
  - Make sure to download software from trusted / recognized websites only.
  - Don't use pirated software.
  - In case of copying data and installing software through portable device such as USB, always scan the device for viruses first.
3. **Don't share Personal Information**
  - Personal information can be used a number of ways by hackers and scammers.
  - Direct information like Social Security numbers or account numbers can be sold or used to access money or loans.
  - Even sharing small bits of information can come back to hurt you.
4. **Ignore spam:**
  - Beware of email messages from unknown parties.
  - Don't click on links or download files from unsolicited emails.
  - Don't reply to emails asking you to update or verify account information.
5. **Back up:**
  - You should always keep backup (multiple copies) of your data. The backup will be useful if a virus deletes your data or modifies it.
  - An external hard drive can also provide enough space for backups, so utilize it.
6. **Log-out:**
  - Don't let a web browser remember your passwords, and make sure to log-out of any accounts when you're done.
  - Always log-out from online accounts, and sign-out the emails, especially when you are using public computers or public Wi-Fi.
  - Anyone can access your information if accounts or emails are not properly logged out.
7. **Sell Devices Safely:**
  - When it's time to move on from an old computer or phone, be sure to wipe personal information from it.
  - By clearing out a computer, you prevent the next user from misusing that data.
8. **Install antivirus software:**

- Antivirus is a kind of software used to prevent, scan, detect and delete viruses from a computer.
- Install the latest antivirus software on your computer.
- You should periodically update antivirus software because older versions of antivirus programs may not detect the new viruses.

#### 9. Use a firewall:

- Firewall is software designed to create a barrier between your information and the outside world.
- Make sure the firewall is enabled in your computer.

### **Lesson 11: Scheduling the Study: Best Practices**

Doing well on an exam involves preparation, which means developing a schedule so that you can study material timely rather than the night before an exam. How can students put all those effective strategies together to develop a coherent study plan? Make a study schedule!

Try to list down your daily activities along with approximate time required for each activity. This will help you in effectively managing your time. Let's watch a video to learn more about it.

#### **Content for Video:**

- I. What is a Study Plan?
- II. Why do I need a Study Plan?
- III. Tips for creating a Study Plan

##### I. What is a Study Plan?

- A study plan is an organized schedule, outlining study times and learning goals.
- Just like with work or school schedules, university students should develop a schedule that sets a dedicated time each week for studying.
- This schedule should include dates of quizzes, tests, and exams, as well as deadlines for papers and projects.

##### II. Why do I need a study plan?

- A study plan is an effective way to help you navigate through your university education, and hold you accountable for your own learning outcomes.
- Study plans are particularly important for online students, since you need to have self-discipline and determination to complete your studies without the constant reminders of an instructor.

##### III. Tips for creating a Study Plan

Follow the guidelines given below to get started on creating your study plan:

*1. Analyze your current study habits and learning style:*

- Think about what works and what doesn't work for you.
- Are you able to study for long blocks of time once or twice a week, or is it more effective if you study nightly for thirty minutes?
- Are you more productive at a certain time of day?
- Do you retain material better if you study a subject immediately after class, or do you need a break first?

*2. Evaluate your current schedule and time management:*

- Use a digital or paper calendar to block out all of your standing commitments, including classes, work, and extracurricular activities. This will let you see how much of your time is already reserved for, and what time you have available for studying. For the ease of VU students in this regard, VU-LMS contains "Lecture Schedule" and "To Do Calendar" sections. The students may facilitate themselves using these sections while scheduling their study.
- If your schedule leaves little room for studying, you may need to evaluate what you can cut back on, or how you can rearrange your schedule to have more open time for studying.

*3. Plan how much time you need to study for each class:*

- For many years, the accepted rule has been that you need to study two hours for every one hour of class time, meaning that if you're taking a typical 15-credit semester, you will spend 30 hours a week outside of class studying.
- VU Students can know about the academic activities such as assignments, graded discussions, Viva voce, Midterm and Final Term Examinations through Index/Lesson section available at VU-LMS, where (for the ease of the students) these activities are mentioned with respect to the number of lessons after which these activities will be conducted.
- You can use these as guide for calculating how much time to set aside for each class, as some courses might be more intensive than others. It will also help you schedule your study sessions to make sure you have enough time to complete all your academic activities and prepare for exams.

*4. Develop a schedule:*

- Now, that you understand how much time you need for studying, and how much time you have available, you can schedule your study sessions.
- Add your study sessions to your calendar like any other commitments. This ensures that you remember this is time set aside specifically for studying.
- Plan out which subject you will study on which day, to ensure that you're devoting enough time to each subject.



- For example, Mondays and Thursdays can be set aside for Math, while Tuesdays and Fridays can be devoted to English.

*5. Assess your weekly calendar:*

- Identifying your learning goals for each class will help you determine how much time you need to spend studying.
- At the start of the term, think about what you want to accomplish in each class. Maybe you want to master a specific skill, or improve your grade. These are overarching goals to help motivate you during the term.
- Then, at the beginning of each week, determine why you need to study and what you plan to accomplish in each study session.
- Are you preparing for a big exam?
- Is there a pending paper?
- Are you able to read a chapter ahead in preparation for the next few classes?
- Adjust your study plan as necessary to meet your weekly goals, and get the most out of each study session.

*6. Stick to your schedule:*

- A study plan works best when it is followed consistently.
- You should try to develop a study plan that you can follow for the length of each term.
- You will have to adjust your plan as necessary when you switch your classes each term.
- Remember, the most important thing is sticking to your plan.

**Lesson 12: Preparing Yourself for Examination: Best Practices**

Mid and final term exams are among the most challenging aspects of the university experience. There is so much to learn, keep organized, and remember as you head into finals. Following video contains some effective preparing tips that can help reduce stress and increase your grade point average in exams.

**Content for Video:**

Studying and preparing is vital to success in exams. Here are some tips which will help you to both studies better, and perform better in the exams.

*1. Start your revision early:*

- You need to give yourself enough time to review everything that you have studied, and make sure that you understand it (or to read round the subject or ask for help if you are struggling). You can take help / guidance from your course Instructor in this regard. Watch the video lectures; study the course handouts / notes and the recommended books. In case



of confusion about any topic, concept or related matters such as exam syllabus, duration and pattern etc., you should consult with your course instructor through:

- Moderated Discussion Board available on VU-LMS
- Email at course email ID or at Instructor's email ID.
- Live session as per schedule provided to you by the course instructor.
- Ideally, review each subject as you go, and make sure that you understand it fully as this will make revision much easier.

## 2. Organize your study time:

- It is also helpful to consider when and how long you plan to spend studying each day.
  - How much time will you be able to manage each day?
  - Can you do more reading at particular times?
  - When is the best time of day for you (morning, afternoon or evening)?
- This will help you to plan broadly what you intend to do, although you should always make sure that you leave it flexible enough to adapt later if circumstances change.

## 3. Look after yourself during study and exam time:

- You will be able to work better if you eat a healthy diet, and get plenty of sleep.
- This applies both during your exam period, and when you are revising.
- Surviving on junk food is not a good idea.
- It is also a good idea to take regular exercise when studying.
- A brisk walk, or more vigorous exercise, will get your blood moving and ensure that you are better able to concentrate.

## 4. Vary your revision techniques:

- It is said that variety is the spice of life, and it certainly helps to improve your studying.
- Always doing the same thing.
  - For example, reading over your notes on a subject—is likely to be quite dull.
- Spice up your revision period by trying different exercises and techniques.

## 5. Take regular breaks

- You cannot work solidly for 8 hours.
- In fact, it is very hard to work in a concentrated way for more than about an hour.
- You may find that some days you can do more, but mostly, one to one and a half hours is likely to be your limit before you need a break.

## 6. Know your exam:

- You should be well aware about your exams such as:
  - Exam Date Sheet (When your exams will start).
  - Exam Syllabus (How many lectures are included in your exam)
  - Exam / Paper Pattern such as types of questions (descriptive or multiple choice) and their ratio / portion of the types of questions in the exam
  - Duration of the exam
  - Exams rules and regulations
- This will ensure that you are prepared for the type of exam you will be sitting, whether multiple choice, short answer or long.
- Know what you are expected to do.
  - For example, how many questions from each section will you have to answer?
- Make sure that you have practiced the right type of questions, and know what will be expected of a 'good' and 'bad' answer.

**BS English (Applied Linguistics)**

<https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029VaazKAVBfxoDMH4l9U0u>